Selecting the Right Mode: Symmetry-Aware, Orbit-Consistent Tesseract Trees on Frozen Foundation Features for 6D Object Pose Estimation

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Abstract

We study 6D pose estimation of known objects with a deliberately lightweight design: one frozen foundation backbone and one core algorithm are shared by every application, and only a small downstream head is trained per application. Two frozen backbones (DINOv3 for appearance, MoGe-2 for surface geometry) feed small autoregressive Transformers (2.4 M parameters per branch) that predict a rotation as a root-to-leaf path in a hierarchical tesseract partition of $SO(3)$. The branches are fused per tree level by a training-free product of experts, and a translation block on the same tokens completes the 6D pose. Single-view pose often fails not because the correct pose cannot be represented, but because it is not selected*: symmetric objects have several equally correct rotations, and nearly symmetric ones have look-alike rotations that are wrong. Three components address selection: (i)* symmetry-aware multi-path targets *that spread the training signal over all equivalent rotations; (ii)* orbit voting*, which scores hierarchical hypotheses for consistency across in-plane rotations of the crop through an exactly derived camera-roll transform; and (iii)* orbit distillation *of that consistency into single-view students. On general objects, multi-path targets improve T-LESS at every recall threshold (orbit R@10* $73.5\% \rightarrow 79.0\%$*) and every SYMSOL-T shape (mean* $2.62^\circ \rightarrow 2.07^\circ$*), and synthetic training data reduces the validation-selected YCB-V error from* 69° *to* 12.9°*. As an application under a hard synthetic-to-real shift, the same design estimates spacecraft pose on SPEED+, where orbit voting and distillation reduce the real-domain error from* $26.9^\circ/36.7^\circ$ *to* $11.2^\circ/11.1^\circ$*. Absolute accuracy remains below fine-tuned state-of-the-art methods. We report matched comparisons, pre-registered ablations, negative results and the deployment cost of the downstream head throughout.*

1. Introduction

Estimating the 6D pose of a known object from one image underlies robotic grasping and bin picking, augmented reality, inspection and autonomous docking. Each of these applications has its own objects, sensors and lighting, and today each typically fine-tunes its own network. Foundation backbones change this trade-off: their features already encode appearance and geometry well enough that, in principle, one frozen backbone and one core pose algorithm could serve every application, with only a small *downstream head* trained per object or product. We call this setting *artificial specific intelligence*: a shared general-purpose model specialised to many narrow tasks by small, cheap, separately deployable heads. This paper asks how far such a design gets on 6D object pose, and what has to be solved to make it work.

A large part of the remaining error comes from *ambiguity*. A symmetric object has several rotations that produce the same image, and every one of them is correct. A nearly symmetric object has look-alike rotations that differ only in small details, and only one of them is correct. Under a domain shift (renders to real images, new lighting), those small details are exactly what becomes unreliable. Distributional pose methods [7, 13, 16] can represent such multi-modal posteriors, but a single prediction still has to *select* a mode.

Our design keeps both backbones frozen. DINOv3 [22] gives robust appearance features, and MoGe-2 [24] gives per-pixel surface normals. The downstream head predicts the rotation as a path in a hierarchical partition of $SO(3)$ derived from the recursive tesseract subdivision [15]. It is an autoregressive Transformer that first chooses one of 4 charts, then one of 8 children at each of 5 levels (131,072 cells), attending to the frozen tokens. The DINOv3 and MoGe-2 trees are fused per level by a training-free product of experts (PoE) [9], and a translation block on the same tokens completes the 6D pose. Only 2.4 M parameters per branch are trained, about 9 MB at fp32; the backbone, the training recipe and the inference algorithm are the same for every application.

Hierarchical hypotheses make selection explicit, and we attack it at three points. *During training*, the target of a symmetric object is the whole set of equivalent rotations, so the tree learns to split its probability between them instead of fitting an arbitrary label (Sec. 3.3). *At test time*, we use the fact that rotating the crop in the image plane is an exact camera roll. A wrong look-alike pose tends to win only in some rotated views, whereas the true pose, mapped back through the known transform, is consistent across all of them. *Orbit voting* collects the tree's beam candidates from four rotated views and scores each candidate by its tree likelihood as seen from every view (Sec. 3.5). Finally, *orbit distillation* trains single-view students towards the orbit system's consensus (Sec. 3.6).

We evaluate on three general-object benchmarks that stress different kinds of ambiguity: textureless industrial parts with continuous and discrete symmetries (T-LESS), exactly symmetric solids (SYMSOL-T) and cluttered household objects (YCB-V). We then apply the same design to a demanding downstream application: spacecraft pose under a synthetic-to-real shift (SPEED+ [19]), where only renders are available for training. There, an audit shows that the real-domain errors are dominated by 180° flips of a nearly symmetric target, and that an oracle picking the best of the tree's own candidates reaches 9.8°, against 26.9° for the prediction (Sec. 4.3): the correct mode is usually present but not selected.

Our contributions are:

- A frozen-backbone 6D pose design in which only a small hierarchical head (2.4 M parameters per branch) is trained per application, with training-free per-level PoE fusion of appearance and geometry. The same backbone, recipe and inference algorithm are used on all four benchmarks; per-application options (fusion, orbit voting) are chosen on validation data. We report the head's deployment cost and its accuracy under reduced precision (Appendix J.4).
- Symmetry-aware multi-path targets for hierarchical rotation trees. They improve T-LESS at every recall threshold and every SYMSOL-T shape, and, unlike canonical labels, remain compatible with orbit voting (Secs. 4.2 and 5).
- Orbit voting with an exactly derived roll transform for hierarchical candidates, and orbit distillation into single-view students. On the spacecraft application they repair 62–80% of severe flips while breaking 0.4% of good predictions, and reduce the real-domain error to $11.2^\circ/11.1^\circ$ (Sec. 4.3).
- An evaluation with comparisons matched to published protocols where possible, three seeds, pre-registered criteria, selection on validation data only, and full reporting of negative results, including where the shared design does *not* transfer: orbit voting hurts on YCB-V, MoGe-2 fusion does not help everywhere, and heads do not transfer zero-shot to new objects (Secs. 4 and 5).

Symmetry-aware losses, test-time augmentation and self-distillation are established ideas. Our claim concerns their exact geometric form for hierarchical rotation hypotheses and their measured effect on mode selection, not the ideas themselves. We do not claim a new state of the art: fine-tuned methods remain more accurate on every benchmark we use.

2. Related Work

Object pose estimation. Learning-based 6D pose estimators regress poses directly or predict 2D–3D correspondences followed by PnP [25]. The BOP benchmark [11] standardises evaluation on datasets such as T-LESS [10] and YCB-V [25], where textureless and symmetric objects remain the hardest cases. Most of these methods train or fine-tune a network per dataset or per object set. We instead keep the foundation backbones frozen and shared, and ask how far small, selection-aware heads can take them.

Spacecraft pose as an application. Synthetic-to-real transfer is studied in its purest form on SPEED+ [19], where models train on renders of a spacecraft and are tested on hardware-in-the-loop captures. There, keypoint-and-PnP pipelines with fine-tuned backbones lead [17, 18, 20, 23]; the most accurate recent result fine-tunes DINOv3 with LoRA and reports that a head on *frozen* DINOv3 features fails with frequent flips [3]. Direct regressors are faster but less accurate [1, 5, 26]. We use this benchmark as a demanding downstream application of the general design, not as its target.

Discrete and distributional rotation prediction. Uniform $SO(3)$ grids can be built from the Hopf fibration [27] or by recursive tesseract subdivision [15]; we adapt the latter to cell-centre representatives with unique paths. Grid- and implicit-density methods model multi-modal rotation posteriors, through MLP scores over grids [12, 16] or equivariant spherical features [14]; parametric alternatives include Bingham mixtures [4]. SpyroPose [7] evaluates a hierarchical $SE(3)$ pyramid coarse to fine, and LiePose [13] applies score-based diffusion on $SE(3)$ and handles symmetric objects well. Continuous rotation regression has known representation issues [28]. Riemannian [2] and discrete [6] flow matching provide generative alternatives; we tested both as refiners and report them as negative results.

Consistency, test-time augmentation and distillation. Averaging predictions over transformed inputs is a standard route to test-time robustness, and four-rotation test-time augmentation is also used for spacecraft keypoints [3]. Data distillation [21] turns multi-transform ensembles into training

targets, a form of knowledge distillation [8]. Equivariant architectures build rotation consistency into the network [14]. Our orbit voting is a test-time augmentation over in-plane rotations, and orbit distillation is a data-distillation variant. What is specific here is the exact camera-roll transform for crops of off-axis objects, scoring with hierarchical tree likelihoods rather than averaging point estimates, and the target: a diagnosed mode-selection failure.

3. Method

Figure 1 gives an overview of training and inference.

3.1. Problem setup

Given a square crop of a known object around its bounding box (15% margin per side), we predict the rotation $q \in SO(3)$ (unit quaternion, $q \equiv -q$) of the object frame relative to the camera and the translation $t \in \mathbb{R}^3$. For objects that appear away from the optical axis (T-LESS, YCB-V), the tree predicts the *allocentric* rotation $R_{\text{ray}}(t)^\top R$, which removes the viewing-ray component so that the crop's appearance depends only on the predicted rotation; it is converted back exactly. Rotation error is $E_R = 2 \arccos |\langle \hat{q}, q \rangle|$, minimised over the object's symmetry set $\mathcal{S}$ when one exists ($\min_{S \in \mathcal{S}} E_R(\hat{q}, q\,S)$), and translation error is $E_T = \|\hat{t} - t\|_2$.

3.2. Tesseract tree on $SO(3)$

Following the recursive tesseract subdivision [15], a quaternion is assigned to a *chart* $c = \arg\max_i |q_i|$, sign-normalised so that $q_c > 0$ (this identifies q and $-q$), and projected to the cube $x = q/q_c$. Its three free coordinates in $[-1, 1]$ are halved recursively, so each level selects one of 8 children. We use *cell centres* (lifted back to the unit sphere) as representatives. Unlike corner representatives, every rotation then has a unique root-to-leaf path. With 4 charts and depth 5 there are $4 \cdot 8^5 = 131{,}072$ cells. The quantisation error of the leaf centre is $2.51°$ on average ($3.97°$ p95, $6.20°$ worst case), and it halves per level. For objects without symmetry this floor bounds the fine accuracy of our rotation results; for symmetric objects the nearest leaf to *any* equivalent rotation is closer.

Tree Transformer. For each backbone, a small decoder predicts the path autoregressively. The frozen tokens are layer-normalised, linearly projected to $d = 256$, given 2-D positional encodings and passed through one encoder layer. A causal decoder with 2 layers (4 heads, FFN 512) then reads a sequence that starts with a root token followed by one token per decided level. Each such token embeds the level and a 6-frequency Fourier encoding of the current cell centre, and cross-attends to the encoded image tokens. The root position predicts the chart (4 logits) and position ℓ predicts the child (8 logits). The model has 2.4 M parameters.

We train with geodesic soft targets: at each level, the target over the candidate cells is $\propto \exp(-(\delta/\tau_\ell)^2)$, where δ is the angle between the ground truth and each cell centre. The widths τ_ℓ ($39.3°$ for the root and level 1, $20.0°$, $10.0°$, $5.0°$, $2.5°$) halve with the cell size. Training uses teacher forcing on the ground-truth path and a cross-entropy at every level; inference is greedy or beam search, and the prediction is the leaf centre.

Frozen features. DINOv3 ViT-L/16 [22] last-layer patch tokens are average-pooled to an 8×8 grid (64×1024). For geometry, MoGe-2 [24] surface normals are masked by a foreground mask on which both backbones agree (the intersection of a DINOv3 foreground estimate and the MoGe-2 mask). They are then pooled to 16×16 cells, each holding three masked-normal channels and the mask fraction (256×4). This consensus mask removes most of MoGe-2's background leakage on real images (Appendix B). Features are extracted once; only the trees are trained.

Per-level product of experts. The two trees are fused without training. At every decoding step, the log-softmax distributions of both branches are added and renormalised: $\log p^{(\ell)} \propto \log p^{(\ell)}_{\text{DINO}} + \log p^{(\ell)}_{\text{MoGe}}$. Beam search then runs on the fused tree. We report this *PoE* variant and a faster *DINOv3-only* variant.

3.3. Symmetry-aware multi-path targets

For a symmetric object, the annotated rotation q is one arbitrary member of the equivalence set $\{q\,s : s \in \mathcal{S}\}$, where $\mathcal{S}$ holds the object-frame symmetries (continuous symmetries discretised). Training on q alone (*single label*) gives contradictory targets for identical images. The usual fix maps every label to a *canonical* member, *e.g.* the one closest to identity. This removes the contradiction but makes the target a discontinuous function of the image: two nearly identical views can receive canonical labels far apart, and the in-plane relation of Eq. (2) no longer holds between views. Instead, we train the tree on all equivalent rotations. The loss is the soft-target cross-entropy of Sec. 3.2, averaged over the members of the set, each with teacher forcing along its own path:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{sym}} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{S}'|} \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}'} \mathcal{L}_{\text{GT}}(q\,s), \tag{1}$$

where $\mathcal{S}' = \mathcal{S}$ if $|\mathcal{S}| \le 8$ and otherwise 8 members are drawn per sample and step (an unbiased estimate). The tree learns to split its probability between the equivalent paths, which is the level-marginal target of the whole set. For objects without symmetry Eq. (1) reduces exactly to the standard loss. Right-multiplication by s commutes with the roll of Eq. (2), so augmented views and orbit voting are unchanged; we verified both identities numerically ($< 10^{-9}$).

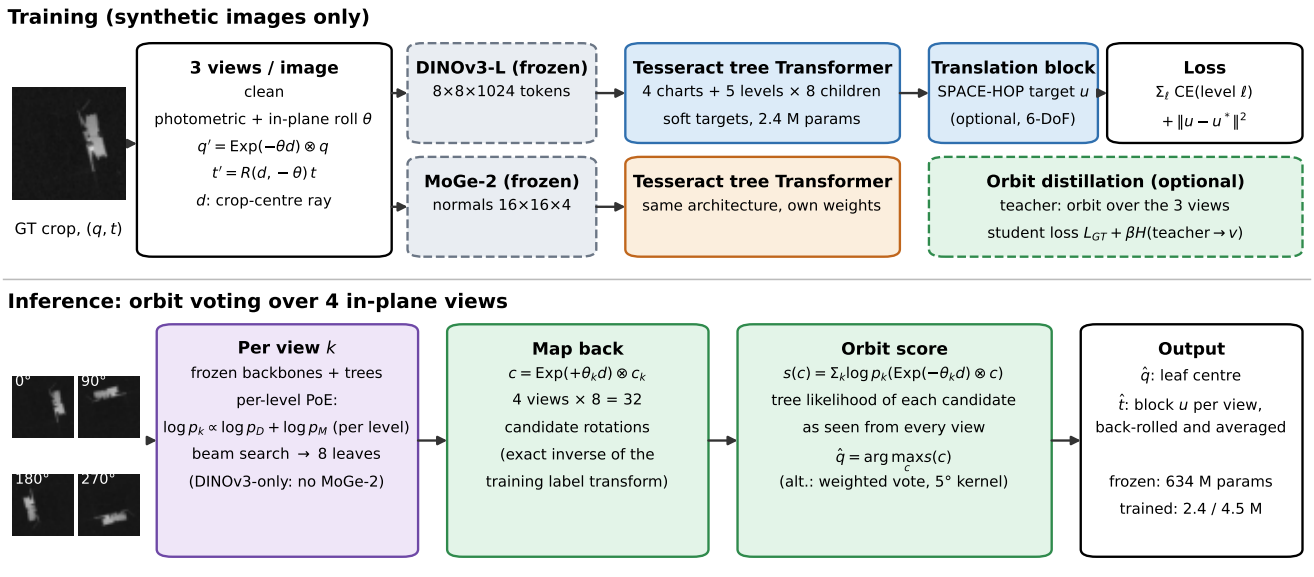


Figure 1. **Overview.** *Top:* training. Each synthetic crop is used as a clean view and as two augmented copies (photometric augmentation plus an in-plane roll θ with exactly transformed labels). Frozen DINOv3 and MoGe-2 features feed one tesseract tree Transformer each; an optional translation block reads the same tokens, and optional orbit distillation replaces the ground-truth target by an orbit teacher. *Bottom:* orbit voting at test time. Candidates from four rotated views are mapped back to a common frame and scored by their per-level PoE tree likelihood in every view.

3.4. Augmentation with exact in-plane labels

Each training image is used as a clean crop and as two pre-extracted augmented copies; one of the three is drawn at every step. The augmentations are photometric (brightness, contrast, gamma, blur, glare blobs, noise, random erasing, JPEG) plus an in-plane rotation of the crop by $\theta \sim \mathcal{U}(-180°, 180°)$ about its centre. Rotating the crop about its centre is equivalent to rotating the camera about the unit ray d through the crop centre, computed with the lens distortion removed. Points therefore transform as $p' = R(d, -\theta)\, p$, and the labels as

$$q' = \mathrm{Exp}(-\theta\, d) \otimes q, \qquad t' = R(d, -\theta)\, t. \tag{2}$$

We derived this convention from the camera geometry rather than fitting it to a predictor. Projecting model keypoints with q' reproduces the warped image to $0.2°$ (p95 label error measured by PnP). For datasets whose objects lie far from the optical axis (T-LESS, YCB-V), an affine crop rotation is not exactly a camera roll (label error up to $6.7°$). There we warp with the roll homography $KR(d, -\theta)K^{-1}$ instead, which makes Eq. (2) exact (verified to $0.000°$).

3.5. Orbit voting

At test time we form $K{=}4$ views of the crop rotated by $\theta_k \in \{0°, 90°, 180°, 270°\}$. In view k the fused tree's beam search returns 8 leaves $c_{k,1..8}$, which are mapped back to the original frame by the inverse of Eq. (2), $c = \mathrm{Exp}(+\theta_k d) \otimes c_k$, giving 32 candidates. Each candidate c is then scored by the tree likelihood of its own path when mapped into every view:

$$s(c) = \sum_{k=1}^{K} \log p_k\big(\mathrm{path}(\mathrm{Exp}(-\theta_k d) \otimes c)\big), \tag{3}$$

and predict $\hat{q} = \arg\max_c s(c)$. Here $\log p_k$ sums the fused root and child log-probabilities along the path, evaluated with teacher forcing. A $180°$ look-alike that wins in one view must also be likely in the other three to be selected, whereas the true pose is consistent by construction. We also evaluate a *weighted vote*, in which each candidate collects Gaussian-kernel support ($5°$) from the other candidates, weighted by their normalised beam probabilities within their view. Orbit voting has no parameters and multiplies inference cost by about $4\times$ (Tab. 6).

3.6. Orbit distillation

Orbit voting is more accurate than a single view, so we use it as a teacher. For every training image we run the frozen orbit system over its three available views (clean and two augmented, with known rolls). This gives 24 candidates in the clean frame with weights $w_j = \mathrm{softmax}_j\, s(c_j)$. A new tree per branch is then trained from scratch with the same

recipe and the loss

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{GT}}(v) - \frac{\beta}{L+1} \sum_j w_j \sum_{\ell=0}^{L} \log p^{(\ell)}\big(\mathrm{pre}_\ell(\mathrm{Exp}(-\theta_v d) \otimes c_j)\big), \tag{4}$$

with $\beta = 1$ and pre_ℓ the length-ℓ path prefix. Here v is the view drawn for the image, and the teacher candidates are transported into its frame. The student is a single-view model with unchanged inference cost; at test time it can be used alone or with orbit voting. This is a data-distillation scheme [21] applied to hierarchical rotation targets.

3.7. Translation block (6-DoF)

For translation we keep the SPACE-HOP parameterisation [5] unchanged. With box centre (b_x, b_y) and size (b_w, b_h), image size (W, H), intrinsics (f_x, f_y, c_x, c_y) and $\alpha = 1.6$, the target is $u = (U_x, U_y, U_z)$ with

$$U_x = \tfrac{1}{b_w}\big(f_x \tfrac{X}{Z} + c_x - b_x\big), \quad U_y = \tfrac{1}{b_h}\big(f_y \tfrac{Y}{Z} + c_y - b_y\big), \tag{5}$$

$$U_z = \tfrac{1}{2}\big(\tfrac{\alpha b_w}{W} + \tfrac{b_h}{H}\big) Z, \tag{6}$$

trained with $\|u - u^*\|^2$ and inverted in closed form. A translation block (one learned query cross-attending to the tree's encoded tokens, then an MLP) predicts u. It is trained either jointly with the tree ($\mathcal{L}_{\text{tree}} + \mathcal{L}_{\text{trans}}$) or on a frozen tree. Rolled views use t' from Eq. (2) with the unchanged box. With orbit voting, each view's $\hat{t}$ is rolled back and the four are averaged.

4. Experiments

4.1. Benchmarks and protocol

Benchmarks. We use three general-object benchmarks that stress different kinds of ambiguity, and one downstream application. Every benchmark uses the same frozen backbones, the same head architecture, training recipe and inference algorithm; only the heads are trained. **T-LESS** [10]: textureless industrial parts with continuous, discrete or no symmetries. We use 7 objects spanning these classes (1, 4, 5, 11, 18, 21, 27), train on PBR renders and real training images, select on held-out PBR scenes, and test on all real BOP19 targets [11] of these objects. **SYMSOL-T**: five symmetric solids (tetrahedron, cube, icosahedron, cone, cylinder) with random translations, rendered with LiePose's generator and seeds [13] (so the images follow its protocol but are not guaranteed identical to its published sets). **YCB-V** [25]: household objects in cluttered real videos. We use 6 objects without declared symmetries (cracker box, mustard bottle, banana, mug, power drill, scissors), validate on held-out real sequences and test on the real keyframes. **Application: SPEED+** [19]: spacecraft pose estimation for autonomous rendezvous, with a nearly symmetric target and a hard synthetic-to-real shift: 47,966 synthetic training and 11,994 synthetic validation images, tested on two real domains, *lightbox* (6,740) and *sunlamp* (2,791). Training uses synthetic images only.

Protocol. Experiments followed pre-registered protocols: question, arms, controls and pass criterion were fixed before each run, and protocol changes were recorded before the affected runs. Post-hoc analyses are labelled as such. We train 3 seeds and report mean ± seed standard deviation; a criterion passes if the difference exceeds the larger seed standard deviation. Checkpoints, hyper-parameters and variants are selected on validation data only; real test sets are never used for selection. One tree per object and branch is trained with the same recipe on every dataset. Two inference options are chosen per application on its validation data, never on test data: the variant (PoE or DINOv3-only) and whether to use orbit voting. Errors are averaged per object and then over objects. Unless stated otherwise, crops come from ground-truth boxes (Sec. 6). Failed criteria and negative results are reported (Appendix C).

Implementation. Trees are trained for 100 epochs with batch 256, AdamW (learning rate 10^{-3}, weight decay 0.05, one-cycle schedule) and bf16, which takes about 3–20 minutes per tree on one shared GPU (about 13 minutes for a DINOv3 tree under the locked SPEED+ recipe; Appendix J.2). Timings are measured end-to-end at batch 1 on a shared NVIDIA RTX 6000 Ada and are upper bounds.

4.2. General objects

This section compares the shared design with published results on the three general-object benchmarks.

T-LESS (Tab. 1). Orbit voting raises recall at all thresholds for the single-label trees (R@10 68.1 → 73.5%), and canonical labels help the single view but break orbit voting (Sec. 5). Multi-path targets (A2) are best at every threshold, with or without orbit voting: with orbit voting, R@2/5/10 rise to 5.7/48.1/79.0% and the mean error falls to 15.2°, and on validation the orbit error drops from 9.25° (A0) to 8.28°, which passes the pre-registered criterion. Unlike canonical labels, multi-path targets keep orbit voting effective. LiePose is clearly more accurate, especially at fine thresholds (R@2 34.9% vs. 5.7%). Three factors are confounded in this gap: LiePose fine-tunes its backbone on all 30 objects, it masks the crop with the ground-truth visible mask, and our depth-5 leaves quantise rotations to 2.5° on average, which caps R@2.

Method	Inference	R@2	R@5	R@10	mean (°)
LiePose [13]	1 sample	34.9	78.2	88.9	–
Ours, A0	1 view	2.3	27.0	68.1	17.9
	orbit (4)	4.0	36.0	73.5	16.6
Ours, A1	1 view	3.6	33.8	73.4	16.7
	orbit (4)	2.7	26.7	65.9	18.2
Ours, A2	1 view	4.5	40.6	76.5	15.7
	orbit (4)	5.7	48.1	79.0	15.2
Ours, A2 + distill.	1 view				
	orbit (4)				

Table 1. **T-LESS**, real BOP19 test targets of our 7 objects. Symmetry-aware rotation recall (%) at 2/5/10° and mean error, PoE variant, 3 seeds. LiePose numbers are its per-object results (Tab. 8 of [13]) averaged over the same 7 objects; it fine-tunes its backbone jointly on all 30 objects and multiplies the crop by the ground-truth visible mask. Ours: frozen backbones, ground-truth box, no mask; continuous symmetries (objects 1 and 4) are discretised in 10° steps for the error, which can add up to 5° for those objects. A0/A1/A2: single, canonical and multi-path targets (Sec. 3.3). Blank cells: runs not yet completed.

Method	tet	cube	icosa	cone	cyl	avg.
LiePose [13]	0.59	0.58	0.64	0.54	0.41	0.55
Ours, A0 + orbit	3.06	2.90	3.71	1.79	1.65	2.62
Ours, A2 + orbit	2.46	2.30	2.52	1.57	1.48	2.07
Ours, A2 + distill. + orbit						

Table 2. **SYMSOL-T** test, symmetry-aware mean rotation error (°) per shape. Ours: DINOv3 variant (selected on validation), orbit voting, 3 seeds. LiePose: SE(3) model, Tab. 3 of [13]. Blank cells: runs not yet completed.

Training data	Feat.	Inference	val	test	test acc@10
real videos	DINOv3	1 view	64.3 ±11.6	71.2 ±7.0	8%
	DINOv3	orbit (4)	63.0 ±2.4	69.4 ±5.2	9%
	PoE	1 view	73.5 ±6.8	81.1 ±7.3	16%
	PoE	orbit (4)	74.1 ±7.4	79.9 ±3.2	18%
+ synthetic (ours)	DINOv3	1 view	9.0 ±1.1	12.9 ±6.9	85%
	DINOv3	orbit (4)	11.5 ±1.8	13.4 ±4.7	83%
	PoE	1 view	10.5 ±0.9	10.9 ±4.1	87%
	PoE	orbit (4)	12.7 ±1.0	12.2 ±5.5	84%

Table 3. **YCB-V**, 6 objects, rotation error (°) on held-out real sequences (val) and real keyframes (test), and the share of test predictions within 10°. Adding synthetic renders composited on real training backgrounds turns a failure into a working model.

SYMSOL-T (Tab. 2). Multi-path targets lower the error on every shape, from 2.62° to 2.07° on average. For symmetric shapes this is below the 2.31° error of the ground-truth rotation's own leaf, because the tree may pick the leaf closest to *any* equivalent rotation. LiePose remains about 4× more accurate; closing the gap needs a continuous refinement on top of the selected leaf.

Dataset	Method	T@2	T@5	T@10	mean E_T
T-LESS	LiePose [13]	68.0	88.4	95.2	–
	box only				
	ours, 1 view				
	ours, orbit mean				
YCB-V	box only	16.0	44.7	76.7	8.14
	ours, 1 view	73.0	96.0	99.9	1.57
	ours, orbit mean	68.8	92.9	99.6	1.83
SYMSOL-T	box only				
	ours, 1 view				
	ours, orbit mean				

Table 4. **Translation on general objects**, real test sets, ground-truth boxes. Translation recall (%) within 2/5/10 cm and mean error (cm; SYMSOL-T in scene units). Box only: the translation implied by the ground-truth box and the training-mean depth scale; ours: the DINOv3 translation block on the frozen selected tree (Sec. 3.7), from the original view or averaged over the 4 orbit views. 3 seeds. LiePose: average over the same 7 T-LESS objects (Tab. 8 of [13]). SYMSOL-T is in scene units, so only the mean distance is reported. Blank cells: runs not yet completed.

YCB-V (Tab. 3). Trained on the real training videos alone, the trees fit their training frames but memorise video context and fail on new sequences (test 69–81°; Appendix G). Adding the standard synthetic renders, pasted onto real training-sequence backgrounds, turns this into a working model. The configuration selected on validation (DINOv3, single view, 9.0° validation) reaches 12.9° on the real test keyframes, with 85% of predictions within 10°; the PoE single-view model is better on test (10.9°, 87%) but is not the validation choice. Five of the six objects reach 4–8°, and the thin, near-planar scissors remain the main failure (Tab. 18). Unlike on the other benchmarks, orbit voting does *not* help on YCB-V: it raises the validation error from 9.0° to 11.5° (DINOv3) and from 10.5° to 12.7° (PoE). We have not yet diagnosed why; one hypothesis is that, with cluttered real backgrounds and a narrow range of camera roll in the training videos, the rotated views are scored less reliably than the original view (Appendix J.3). Published YCB-V results use BOP or ADD(-S) metrics on all 21 objects with detected boxes, so we do not place our numbers in those tables.

Translation (Tab. 4). The translation block is the same on every dataset (Sec. 3.7) and is trained on the frozen tree selected for rotation, using each dataset's own image size. Its evaluation on T-LESS, SYMSOL-T and YCB-V was pre-registered together with these rotation results. On YCB-V the block passes its criterion clearly: on validation, the orbit-averaged error is 3.4 cm against 10.7 cm for the box alone. On the real test keyframes, the single-view block places 73% of the objects within 2 cm and 96% within 5 cm

(mean 1.6 cm, against 8.1 cm for the box alone). As for rotation, orbit averaging does not help on YCB-V (1.8 cm), and validation selects the single view. T-LESS and SYMSOL-T are still running. On the spacecraft application it is already evaluated (Sec. 4.3).

4.3. Application: spacecraft pose under synthetic-to-real shift

We now apply the same design, unchanged, to spacecraft pose estimation for autonomous rendezvous. Only renders of the spacecraft are available for training, and the test images come from two hardware-in-the-loop facilities. The target is nearly symmetric, so this application stresses exactly the look-alike failure mode that orbit voting targets.

Comparison with published results (Tab. 5). With ground-truth crops, our frozen-feature system reaches $11.2°/11.1°$, close to recent direct methods (PAID-ViT $12.3°/11.8°$) and well ahead of a head on frozen DINOv3 features in the same crop setting ($15.5°/24.5°$ [3]). Fine-tuned keypoint pipelines are far more accurate ($1.2°$–$3.4°$). Our official score with ground-truth crops is $0.227/0.224$ for the distilled system (rotation from the distilled PoE students with orbit voting, translation from the jointly trained DINOv3 block) and $0.241/0.238$ for the jointly trained 6-DoF PoE model. This is similar to SPNv2 without adaptation on sunlamp and to PAID-ViT, and it is dominated by the rotation term. With boxes from a detector trained on synthetic images only (YOLO11s; a missed detection falls back to the full image and is still scored), the same system reaches $23.9°/16.4°$ and a score of $0.523/0.333$. The detector is reliable on synthetic images (mean IoU 0.99) and on sunlamp (0.88, no misses) but not on lightbox (mean IoU 0.76, 16% of boxes below IoU 0.5, 54 misses), so the lightbox gap is mainly a detection problem. Translation suffers most, because our translation target is defined relative to the box ($0.66/0.27$ m against $0.19/0.18$ m with ground-truth boxes). This matched, synthetic-only setting is far behind SPNv2 without adaptation ($0.142/0.230$), which predicts from the full image.

Diagnosis: real-domain errors are flips. Before changing the model, we audited the large real-domain errors of the clean (non-augmented) SPEED+ trees. Encoder and decoder round trips are exact, and the metric, rotation convention and data pipeline were ruled out. Chart seams were ruled out as well: flat Hopf-grid heads on the same features flip as often or more. Of the errors above $90°$, 36–41% lie within $15°$ of $180°$, against 20% for uniformly random wrong rotations. Their body-frame rotation axes cluster around a few axes of the near-symmetric spacecraft. Allowing a $180°$ rotation about one body axis lowers the lightbox mean of the DINOv3 tree from $38.9°$ to $23.5°$. The correct mode is usually available: among the tree's beam candidates and their $180°$ flips, an oracle achieves $9.8°$ on lightbox, against $26.9°$ for the fused greedy prediction. Neither a continuous flow posterior, flow-based re-noise scoring, synthetic templates nor a discrete path flow selects it on real images (Appendix C). The problem is *mode selection* under domain shift.

Orbit voting and distillation. Table 6 summarises the progression. Augmentation alone (photometric plus roll, single view) cuts the real-domain error of the PoE system from $26.9°/36.7°$ to $17.3°/20.2°$. Orbit voting then brings it to $12.3°/12.3°$ and the synthetic error to $3.87°$. It repairs 62% and 80% of the severe flips on lightbox and sunlamp while breaking only 0.4% of good predictions (Tab. 14). The median errors on real images are $5.3°$ and $6.3°$, so the remaining means are driven by a tail of failures. Orbit distillation improves every setting. The single-view students recover 13–43% of the orbit gain at single-view cost; for example, the PoE greedy error on lightbox drops from $17.3°$ to $15.9°$. Students with orbit voting give the best system: $3.69°$ synthetic and $11.21°/11.09°$ on lightbox/sunlamp, about twice the seed std better than the undistilled orbit system, with fewer severe flips. For distillation, synthetic validation ranks the systems in the same order. For the orbit *scoring rule* it does not: the likelihood product was fixed in the base recipe before the scoring ablation was run, and synthetic validation would have selected the weighted vote instead (Sec. 5), which gives $3.27°/11.35°/11.91°$ with the distilled PoE students. MoGe-2 helps on real images: PoE with orbit voting reaches $12.3°$ on lightbox, against $17.4°$ for DINOv3-only. It costs about 50 ms per view, half of which is the CPU consensus-mask step. DINOv3-only orbit voting runs at 14 FPS and a single DINOv3 view at 68 FPS (Appendix A).

Full 6-DoF. Table 15 (supplementary) adds translation with the SPACE-HOP target [5]. Because our crops come from ground-truth boxes, the box alone already locates the target to 0.55 m. The translation block improves on this by about 7–10× on synthetic data (both pre-registered criteria pass). Joint training does not hurt rotation and even helps slightly on real images: PoE + orbit reaches $3.86°/12.11°/11.73°$, against $3.87°/12.30°/12.25°$. Orbit averaging lowers translation error by 10–25%. The DINOv3 block is the most accurate on synthetic data (0.059 m) and reaches $0.185/0.183$ m on the real domains; the MoGe-2 block alone is weak for translation. With a synthetic-only detector instead of ground-truth boxes, translation error rises to $0.66/0.27$ m (last row of Tab. 5).

Method	Setting	E_R (°) LB	E_R (°) SL	score LB	score SL
TangoUnchained* [20]	detector + keypoints/PnP, real images	3.19	4.30	0.073	0.090
lava1302* [20]	detector + keypoints/PnP, self-training	6.66	2.73	0.165	0.059
SPNv2 [17]	full image, no adaptation	6.48	11.07	0.142	0.230
SPNv2 + ODR* [17]	+ test-time adaptation	5.58	9.79	0.122	0.197
EagerNet [23]	detector + dense correspondences	1.75	2.66	0.039	0.059
SPNv3-B† [18]	GT crop, keypoints/PnP, fine-tuned	2.03	3.40	0.047	0.074
Church & Nikolian† [3]	GT crop, DINOv3-H+ LoRA, 12 passes	1.17	1.56	0.027	0.038
frozen DINOv3-L + head [3]	GT crop, frozen, 1 pass	15.47	24.49		
FastPose-ViT [1]	detector, direct regression	12.26	18.28		
PAID-ViT [26]	crop, direct regression	12.29	11.76	0.237	0.230
Ours, distilled + orbit	GT crop, frozen, 4 views	11.21	11.09	0.227	0.224
Ours, 6-DoF (joint PoE) + orbit	GT crop, frozen, 4 views	12.11	11.73	0.241	0.238
Ours, distilled + orbit	synthetic-only detector, frozen	23.88	16.42	0.523	0.333

Table 5. **SPEED+ real domains** (lightbox LB, sunlamp SL): mean rotation error and the official SPEED+ score (rotation error in radians plus normalised translation error, averaged over images; lower is better). Published values as reported by each source. * uses real or unlabelled test-domain images during training or adaptation. † ensemble of 3 models. Settings differ (detector or ground-truth crop, fine-tuned or frozen backbone), so only rows with the same setting are matched comparisons. Blank cells: runs not yet completed.

Training	Feat.	Inference	Synth. val	Lightbox	Sunlamp	>150° (%) LB	>150° (%) SL	ms
			mean E_R (°), 3 seeds					
Clean tree (no augmentation)	PoE	1 view	5.54 ±0.07	26.91 ±0.78	36.66 ±0.93	5.9	7.4	64
Augmented tree (base recipe)	DINOv3	1 view	4.84 ±0.05	22.55 ±0.73	22.00 ±0.70	6.0	3.2	15
Augmented tree (base recipe)	DINOv3	orbit (4)	4.21 ±0.04	17.40 ±0.68	15.27 ±0.64	4.8	2.0	70
+ orbit distillation	DINOv3	1 view	4.57 ±0.05	21.61 ±0.82	20.55 ±0.94	5.8	3.1	15
+ orbit distillation	DINOv3	orbit (4)	3.90 ±0.03	16.43 ±0.75	13.64 ±0.57	4.5	1.6	70
Augmented tree (base recipe)	PoE	1 view	4.85 ±0.03	17.33 ±0.31	20.15 ±0.57	4.2	3.3	64
Augmented tree (base recipe)	PoE	orbit (4)	3.87 ±0.03	12.30 ±0.50	12.25 ±0.37	3.0	1.7	279
+ orbit distillation	PoE	1 view	4.56 ±0.03	15.90 ±0.53	18.33 ±0.66	3.7	3.0	64
+ orbit distillation	PoE	orbit (4)	**3.69** ±0.02	**11.21** ±0.42	**11.09** ±0.49	2.6	1.4	279

Table 6. **SPEED+ rotation, ground-truth crops.** Mean E_R over 3 seeds (± seed std), fraction of severe flips (>150°), and end-to-end latency at batch 1. The clean tree is trained without augmentation. The DINOv3 student is distilled from a DINOv3-only orbit teacher, and the PoE students from the PoE orbit teacher. Inference cost is unchanged by distillation.

5. Ablations

All ablations use the PoE variant, 3 seeds and the same evaluation run within each table. The training-target ablation runs on the general-object benchmarks (T-LESS, SYMSOL-T). The ablations of the head architecture, the orbit scoring rule and the augmentation were run on the spacecraft application (SPEED+), where the synthetic-to-real shift makes their effects largest; we do not assume that their magnitudes carry over to the other benchmarks.

Symmetry-aware targets. Table 7 compares the three training targets. Canonical labels (A1) remove the contradiction between equivalent labels and improve single-view accuracy on both datasets (SYMSOL-T 3.87° → 3.40°, T-LESS validation 12.3° → 11.5°). However, they break orbit voting: a canonical label is not related across in-plane rotations by Eq. (2), so the views disagree and the SYMSOL-T orbit error rises to 9.7°. Multi-path targets (A2) keep the relation and are the best single-view and orbit models on SYMSOL-T (2.72° and 2.10°; pre-registered criterion passes by about 100× the seed std).

Hierarchical tree vs. flat grid (SPEED+). We replace the tree with a count-matched flat classifier over 131,076 Hopf-fibration anchors [27] in SPACE-HOP's configuration (10,923 directions × 12 rolls), keeping features, augmentation, training budget and orbit inference identical (Tab. 8). The tree is far more accurate (3.87° vs. 7.53° synthetic with

Training target	Inference	T-LESS (7 obj.) val	T-LESS (7 obj.) test	SYMSOL-T (5) val	SYMSOL-T (5) test
single annotated label	1 view	12.3 ±0.1	17.9 ±0.2	3.87 ±0.03	3.88 ±0.01
	orbit (4)	9.3 ±0.1	16.6 ±0.2	2.65 ±0.01	2.67 ±0.00
canonical label	1 view	11.5 ±0.0	16.7 ±0.1	3.40 ±0.01	3.39 ±0.01
	orbit (4)	10.7 ±0.0	18.2 ±0.7	9.73 ±0.05	9.69 ±0.05
all equivalents (ours)	1 view	10.8 ±0.1	15.7 ±0.2	2.72 ±0.01	2.71 ±0.01
	orbit (4)	8.3 ±0.0	15.2 ±0.3	2.10 ±0.01	2.11 ±0.01
+ orbit distillation	1 view				
	orbit (4)				

Table 7. **Training targets for symmetric objects** (symmetry-aware mean error, PoE). Single annotated label (A0), canonical label closest to identity (A1), and all equivalent rotations (A2, Eq. (1)); the last block adds orbit distillation on top of the selected target. Blank cells: runs not yet completed.

Head (params/branch)	Grid	Floor	Inference	Synth.	LB	SL
Tesseract tree (2.4 M)	131,072 leaves	2.51	1 view	4.85 ±0.03	17.33 ±0.31	20.15 ±0.57
			orbit	3.87 ±0.03	12.30 ±0.50	12.25 ±0.37
Flat (36.1 M)	Hopf 10,923×12	6.06	1 view	8.95 ±0.06	20.56 ±0.70	27.16 ±1.04
			orbit	7.53 ±0.01	13.15 ±0.37	16.31 ±0.59
Flat, same grid	131,072 leaves	2.51	1 view			
			orbit			
Flat, balanced Hopf	Hopf 1,771×74	2.29	1 view			
			orbit			

Table 8. **Tree vs. flat grid** (PoE, mean error in °). Same frozen features, augmentation, training budget and orbit inference (4 views, top-8 per view). Floor: mean error of the nearest anchor (tree: its leaf) on the synthetic-validation rotations. The *same-grid* flat head classifies the tree's own 131,072 leaves, isolating hierarchical prediction; the balanced Hopf grid tests an alternative discretisation of the same size. Blank cells: runs not yet completed.

orbit voting), better on real data in all comparisons, and uses 15× fewer parameters per branch (2.4 M vs. 36.1 M, of which 33.6 M is the 131k-way output layer). Orbit voting helps both heads, and the flat head with orbit voting even has slightly fewer severe flips on lightbox, so flip repair comes mainly from orbit voting.

This comparison does not isolate hierarchical prediction. With only 12 in-plane rolls, the SPACE-HOP grid alone has a quantisation floor of 6.06° on the synthetic-validation rotations, against 2.51° for the tree's leaves, so part of the gap is due to the grid. We therefore run a controlled comparison with two further flat heads, trained with the identical recipe and evaluated with identical orbit inference (4 views, top-8 candidates per view, orbit-product scoring). The first classifies the tree's *own* 131,072 leaf centres, and scores an orbit candidate by the probability of its Tesseract cell, exactly as the tree does; only the prediction (hierarchical vs. flat) differs. The second classifies a balanced Hopf grid of 1,771 Fibonacci directions × 74 rolls (131,054 anchors), an alternative discretisation of the same size whose floor (2.29° mean, 3.8° max) is *lower* than the tree's (2.51°, 5.8°). Both flat heads have about 33.6 M output-layer parameters per branch. Their results will fill the blank rows of Tab. 8; if the same-grid flat head matches the tree, the advantage in the first comparison is due to the grid rather than to hierarchical prediction.

Selection over 32 candidates	Synth.	LB	SL
1 view (greedy)	4.85 ±0.03	17.33 ±0.31	20.15 ±0.57
max-confidence	5.51 ±0.03	14.63 ±0.42	15.92 ±0.15
top-1 vote	4.37 ±0.03	13.24 ±0.42	13.38 ±0.57
weighted vote (32)	3.46 ±0.03	12.58 ±0.42	12.88 ±0.49
orbit product	3.87 ±0.03	12.30 ±0.50	12.25 ±0.37

Table 9. **Selection rule over the same 32 orbit candidates.**

Augmentation	1 view Syn.	1 view LB	1 view SL	orbit (4) Syn.	orbit (4) LB	orbit (4) SL
none	5.54 ±0.07	26.90	36.66	4.62 ±0.04	20.25	24.83
photometric	5.00 ±0.03	17.38	19.68	4.25 ±0.06	12.29	12.37
in-plane roll	4.91 ±0.00	24.30	31.52	3.78 ±0.03	18.69	20.70
both	4.85 ±0.03	17.33	20.15	3.87 ±0.03	12.30	12.25

Table 10. **Which augmentation matters.** *None* is the clean tree. The roll uses exact labels (Eq. (2)).

Cost of the output layer. Measured on the prediction head alone with an earlier version of the architecture, a flat 131k-way head is about 3× faster than the tree's greedy decoding on a large GPU at batch 1 (0.40 vs. 1.23 ms), but 1.5× slower at batch 256, 2.7× slower on a small GPU and 7× slower on one CPU thread. Either head is small compared with the backbone (DINOv3 about 6 ms per view), so the tree's practical advantage is its size and its behaviour on constrained hardware, not GPU latency. The controlled comparison above also measures head and full-pipeline latency and training and inference memory for all three heads under identical conditions.

How to select among orbit candidates (SPEED+). With the same 32 candidates (Tab. 9), picking the most confident one is clearly worse than any form of agreement, and voting among the four views' top-1 predictions is better. Using all candidates helps most. The kernel-weighted vote is best on synthetic data (3.46°). The likelihood product of Eq. (3) is best on both real domains, but its advantage over the vote is within about one seed std. Its pre-registered criterion ("product beats voting on synthetic validation") *fails*, and under our selection protocol the weighted vote would be preferred. The product is reported in Tab. 6 only because it was fixed in the base recipe beforehand. We therefore claim multi-view consistency over hierarchical candidates, not a specific scoring rule.

Photometric vs. rotation augmentation (SPEED+). Table 10 separates the two augmentation families. Photometric augmentation with orbit voting reaches $12.3°/12.4°$ on real images, the same as the combined recipe. Rotation augmentation alone gives the best synthetic precision ($3.78°$) but leaves real errors at $18.7°/20.7°$. Orbit voting on the clean tree already removes a quarter to a third of the real error ($26.9° \rightarrow 20.3°$, $36.7° \rightarrow 24.8°$). The real-domain gain therefore comes from *lighting robustness plus orbit consistency*. The exact roll transform is needed for orbit voting itself; as a training augmentation it mainly improves synthetic precision. This corrects our initial hypothesis that rotation augmentation causes the flip repair.

Can training learn orbit consistency (SPEED+). On SPEED+ we compared paired views of the same image (a data control), a transported consistency loss on the leaf distribution (a standard equivariance regulariser), a *hierarchical* transported loss at every tree level, and orbit distillation (Tab. 16, supplementary). The hierarchical loss beats the base recipe and the paired-view control but not the leaf-only loss; its pre-registered criterion fails, so we make no hierarchical-transport claim. Both consistency losses mostly improve synthetic precision. Orbit distillation is the only objective that clearly improves the real domains ($11.2°/11.1°$ with orbit voting).

Further ablations in the supplementary material cover the decoder lineage (MLP, GRU and Transformer decoders, hard vs. soft targets, beam search), fusion (single branches, learned fusion, weighted PoE), finer tokens, continuous flow posteriors and verifiers, discrete flow matching, oracle headroom, zero-shot transfer and timing.

6. Limitations

- **Ground-truth crops.** Most reported results use ground-truth boxes. On SPEED+, a synthetic-only detector roughly doubles the rotation error on lightbox ($11.2° \rightarrow 23.9°$) and raises the score from 0.227 to 0.523, mainly through poor real-domain boxes and the box-relative translation target (Tab. 5). A deployable system therefore needs a detector that transfers to real images, or translation that does not depend on the box.
- **Translation on general objects.** The translation block is evaluated on the spacecraft application; its evaluation on T-LESS, SYMSOL-T and YCB-V is running (Tab. 4), so these datasets are currently compared on rotation only.
- **How general the shared design is.** The backbone, head architecture, recipe and inference algorithm are shared, but two options are chosen per application on validation data: orbit voting helps on T-LESS, SYMSOL-T and SPEED+ but hurts on YCB-V, and MoGe-2 fusion does not help on every dataset. YCB-V also needed synthetic training data. Four domains are evidence for, not proof of, the claim that one backbone and one algorithm serve many applications.
- **Matched comparisons.** Published numbers use different crops, masks, object sets and fine-tuned backbones; Tabs. 1, 2 and 5 state each setting, and only rows with the same setting are matched.
- **Hierarchy vs. grid.** The flat-baseline comparison of Sec. 5 uses a coarser grid than the tree; the same-grid control is still running, so the share of the gain due to hierarchical prediction is not yet established.
- **Quantisation floor.** The depth-5 leaf quantisation ($2.51°$ mean) bounds fine accuracy for asymmetric objects. Our best synthetic SPEED+ errors (3.3–$3.7°$) are close to it, and it caps fine-threshold recall on T-LESS. A continuous refinement on top of the selected mode is a natural next step; the refiners we tried helped only on synthetic data (Appendix C).
- **Per-object heads.** One head is trained per object; there is no zero-shot transfer to new objects (Appendix H). Adding an object means training a new head (minutes on one GPU), not fine-tuning the backbone.
- **Cost.** Orbit voting costs $4\times$ inference, and MoGe-2 fusion does not help on every dataset.
- **Timing.** Timings come from a shared GPU and are upper bounds.

7. Conclusion

One frozen foundation backbone and one core algorithm, specialised to each application by a small trained head, are a competitive basis for 6D object pose when the head's hypotheses are *selected* well. Three components target selection: multi-path targets that spread the training signal over all symmetric equivalents, orbit voting that scores hierarchical hypotheses for consistency across exactly mapped in-plane rotations, and orbit distillation that moves this consistency into single-view students. Multi-path targets improve T-LESS at every recall threshold and every SYMSOL-T shape and, unlike canonical labels, remain compatible with orbit voting. Synthetic training data turns YCB-V from a failure into a working model. The same design carries over unchanged to spacecraft pose under a synthetic-to-real shift, where orbit voting and distillation repair most real-domain flips of the nearly symmetric target. Fine-tuned methods remain more accurate on all four benchmarks, and our evaluation is intentionally conservative; we hope the protocol, the matched comparisons and the negative results are as useful as the method.

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Selecting the Right Mode: Symmetry-Aware, Orbit-Consistent Tesseract Trees on Frozen Foundation Features for 6D Object Pose Estimation

Supplementary Material

A. Timing

System	batch 1		batch 64	
	ms	FPS	ms/img	img/s
DINOv3, 1 view	14.7	68.1	2.9	347
DINOv3 + orbit	69.6	14.4	12.1	82
PoE, 1 view	64.0	15.6	50.0	20
PoE + orbit	278.5	3.6	206.8	5

Table 11. **End-to-end latency** of the augmented trees (shared RTX 6000 Ada; upper bounds; image already decoded).

At batch 1 (Tab. 11), a DINOv3 forward pass takes 6.4 ms and one tree 7.4 ms. MoGe-2 adds 21 ms for the network and 20 ms for the CPU consensus-mask step per view, which is the main optimisation target. Orbit voting multiplies the cost by 4.4–4.7×. Batched evaluation reduces tree cost to 0.1–0.3 ms per image.

B. Model lineage and fusion

Design (clean trees, PoE greedy)	Synth.	LB	SL
MLP path decoder, hard targets	6.24	31.1	43.7
GRU path decoder	6.15	–	40.6
MLP decoder, geodesic soft targets	6.07	28.2	42.1
Transformer decoder, hard targets	5.69	31.6	41.8
Transformer + soft targets	**5.54**	**26.9**	**36.7**
+ beam 8 instead of greedy	no gain	–	–
+ tangent residual at the leaf	−0.13	±0.0	±0.0
16×16 instead of 8×8 DINOv3 tokens	5.56	27.0	36.0
DINOv3 tree alone	5.35	37.1	–
MoGe-2 tree alone	–	43.7	–
Learned concat fusion, one Transformer (8×8)	5.34	40.8	–
Equal per-level PoE (same grid)	5.58	27.9	–
Weighted PoE, w_{DINO}=0.8 (proxy-selected)	5.14	32.0	36.7

Table 12. **Design steps** on clean (non-augmented) trees, seed means. Dashes: not evaluated in that study.

Table 12 lists the design steps that led to the base tree. The Transformer decoder with geodesic soft targets was best; beam search at full data brought no gain, and a tangent residual only refined errors within the correct cell. Fusion is strongly asymmetric across domains. A learned fusion that feeds concatenated tokens into one Transformer matches DINOv3 alone on synthetic data but is much worse on real images (40.8° vs. 27.9° for PoE on the same grid). We interpret this as the learned fusion over-fitting render statistics, while training-free PoE keeps the branches' errors partly independent. A weighted PoE selected on the rotated validation proxy (w=0.8) is 5° worse on lightbox than equal weights. Following our protocol, we did not use real data to choose another weight. The consensus foreground mask reduces MoGe-2's background leakage on real images from 0.52 to 0.12 (lightbox) and from 0.57 to 0.12 (sunlamp). It is what makes the MoGe-2 branch useful.

C. Negative results

Approach (on clean trees unless noted)	Synth.	LB	SL
Clean PoE tree (reference)	5.54	26.9	36.7
$SO(3)$ flow posterior on tree memory, KDE mode	5.22	29.8	37.6
best of 32 samples (*oracle*)	2.60	9.7	10.6
Flow re-noise verifier over beams + flips + corners	4.78	26.5	32.7
best candidate (*oracle*)	2.25	7.9	11.4
Kurz corner tree [15]	5.20	28.8	39.1
Tree distilled from flow masses (β=1, 1 seed)	5.62	26.2	37.7
Discrete flow matching on tree paths	7.22	29.8	39.8
Aug. DINOv3 tree (reference)	4.84	22.6	22.1
+ $SO(3)$ flow, KDE	4.10	25.2	24.4

Table 13. **Refiners and verifiers that did not fix real flips** (seed means). Oracles are not deployable and show headroom only.

Table 13 collects approaches that improved synthetic accuracy but not, or only slightly, real accuracy. A Riemannian flow-matching posterior [2] conditioned on the tree's encoder memory contains good samples: its best-of-32 oracle reaches 9.7° on lightbox. It also assigns the ground truth a much higher log-likelihood than the tree does (3.85 vs. 0.98 nats on lightbox), and its 90% regions over-cover (0.98). Yet its mode estimate is worse than the tree's. Re-scoring an expanded candidate set (beam, 180° flips, cell corners) by re-noise/return consistency helps synthetic data and sunlamp, but does not repair lightbox flips. Synthetic render-and-compare templates also failed to choose the right flip. A discrete flow on the tesseract path [6] was clearly worse. We note that interpolating path tokens is not geometry-preserving: 45–53% of intermediate paths lie more than 30° from both endpoints. Distilling flow masses into the tree did not pass its criterion. An oracle that stops decoding at the best depth would gain only 0.51° on synthetic data, so adaptive depth was not pursued. These results support the diagnosis of Sec. 4.3: the right mode is reachable, but scorers trained on clean synthetic features cannot select it on real images. Lighting-robust training and multi-

view consistency can.

D. Flip transitions on SPEED+

System	Lightbox		Sunlamp	
	fixed	broken	fixed	broken
Aug. tree, 1 view	51% of 401	1.0%	59% of 206	1.0%
Aug. tree + orbit	62% of 401	0.4%	80% of 206	0.4%
Aug. DINOv3 + orbit	52% of 401	1.3%	74% of 206	0.5%

Table 14. **Flip transitions relative to the clean PoE tree.** *Fixed*: share of the clean tree's $>150^\circ$ errors that become $<20^\circ$ (denominator given). *Broken*: share of its $<20^\circ$ predictions that become $>150^\circ$.

E. Orbit distillation and 6-DoF details

Arm	Feat.	$\hat{t}$	E_T (m)			E_R (°), orbit		
			Syn.	LB	SL	Syn.	LB	SL
Box only	–	–	0.561	0.547	0.553	–	–	–
Frozen	DINOv3	1 view	0.090	0.233	0.240	4.21	17.40	15.27
		orbit	0.068	0.205	0.205			
Frozen	PoE	1 view	0.108	0.206	0.232	3.87	12.30	12.25
		orbit	0.089	0.184	0.206			
Joint	DINOv3	1 view	0.078	0.209	0.212	4.19	17.31	14.87
		orbit	**0.059**	0.185	**0.183**			
Joint	PoE	1 view	0.111	0.196	0.221	3.86	12.11	11.73
		orbit	0.093	**0.175**	0.194			

Table 15. **SPEED+ 6-DoF** with the SPACE-HOP translation target, ground-truth crops. Rotation uses PoE or DINOv3 orbit voting. Translation ($\hat{t}$) is predicted from one view or as the orbit average; seed std of $E_T \leq 0.005$ m. *Box only* uses no image: the object centre is placed at the box centre and the depth at the training mean of U_z.

Training objective	1 view, DINOv3		PoE + orbit		
	Syn.	Syn.-rot.	Syn.	LB	SL
Base recipe (GT loss)	4.84 ±0.05	9.88 ±0.22	3.87	12.30	12.25
+ paired views	4.96 ±0.06	10.04 ±0.21	3.94	12.38	12.45
+ leaf-level transported consistency	4.59 ±0.04	9.43 ±0.14	3.71	12.41	11.74
+ hierarchical transported consistency	4.65 ±0.03	9.57 ±0.06	3.74	12.49	11.73
+ orbit distillation	4.57 ±0.05	9.33 ±0.18	**3.69**	**11.21**	**11.09**

Table 16. **Training-time consistency.** Single-view DINOv3 trees on synthetic and rotated synthetic validation (left) and PoE + orbit (right). The consistency losses transport each view's beam distribution into another view's frame via Eq. (2).

Retention of the orbit gain by the single-view students, defined as (base greedy − student greedy)/(base greedy − base orbit), is 43%/18%/22% (DINOv3) and 30%/28%/23% (PoE) on synthetic/lightbox/sunlamp, and 13–15% on the rotated proxy. For the joint 6-DoF model, the ESA-style score (rotation error in radians plus normalised translation error, with the challenge precision floors) is 0.084/0.241/0.238 for PoE.

F. Per-object results

Object	PoE+orbit	DINOv3+orbit
T-LESS		
1	23.82	25.00
4	14.50	15.69
5	6.22	7.07
11	11.90	12.92
18	14.38	14.78
21	34.78	37.24
27	10.36	12.43
SYMSOL-T		
cone	1.83	1.79
cube	2.72	2.90
cyl	1.67	1.65
icosa	3.81	3.71
tet	3.35	3.06
YCB-V		
003_cracker_box	85.27	74.61
006_mustard_bottle	97.96	87.29
011_banana	61.63	83.23
025_mug	24.25	22.76
035_power_drill	41.34	25.07
037_scissors	169.07	123.72

Table 17. **Per-object test error** of the single-label (A0) trees (3-seed mean; symmetry-aware for T-LESS and SYMSOL-T; YCB-V trained on real videos only).

On T-LESS (Tab. 17), most of the test error comes from object 21 (no symmetry metadata, near-symmetric; 18% of predictions above 90°) and object 1 (continuous symmetry). Continuous symmetries are evaluated on a 10°-step discretisation of the symmetry set, which adds up to 5° of artificial error for objects 1 and 4 and for the cone and cylinder.

G. YCB-V diagnosis

On YCB-V we checked four things:

1. The trees fit their training frames: 3.8° and 3.9° on mustard bottle and mug.
2. Test poses are covered by training: the median nearest training rotation is about 5° away for cracker box, mustard bottle and banana, whose test errors are still 75–87°.
3. Every crop contains all of the object's label pixels.
4. The ground-truth rotations agree with the segmentation: 65–98% of the projected model points fall on the object mask, against 28–83% for a transposed-rotation control.

The failure is therefore memorisation of the 16–20 cluttered training videos per object. The object covers only 5–40% of the crop and the DINOv3 tokens are not masked. This

is not a label or pipeline error. Standard YCB-V training adds the synthetic `data_syn` renders, whose backgrounds are black. We pasted each render onto a real frame drawn only from the training sequences (never validation or test), capped at 12,000 crops per object as for the real data, and retrained with the unchanged recipe. Table 18 shows the effect per object.

	real videos		+ synthetic	
Object	DINOv3	PoE	DINOv3	PoE
003_cracker_box	77.7	78.7	5.1	5.7
006_mustard_bottle	101.5	102.4	6.1	7.6
011_banana	79.9	77.6	6.1	5.3
025_mug	24.6	28.4	6.5	5.6
035_power_drill	30.3	38.2	4.3	4.4
037_scissors	113.2	161.5	49.4	36.9

Table 18. **YCB-V per-object test error** (°, single view, 3 seeds) without and with synthetic training data.

H. Zero-shot transfer of the frozen SPEED+ trees

Dataset	Raw E_R		Frame-free pair error		
	frozen	chance	frozen	chance	constant
T-LESS	117.5	103.6	95.4 $\pm$3.0	104.5	88.7
SYMSOL-T	49.4	53.7	47.8 $\pm$0.5	53.7	53.8
YCB-V	115.6	125.8	101.6 $\pm$2.8	125.8	57.8

Table 19. **Zero-shot**: frozen SPEED+ PoE trees with orbit voting, no retraining, test split. The pair error $\min_S \angle(\hat{R}_i \hat{R}_j^\top, R_i S R_j^\top)$ over random same-object pairs cancels the unknown offset between object frames. *Chance*: uniformly random predictions. *Constant*: one rotation predicted for every image.

Object frames are arbitrary, so raw errors are expected near chance. The frame-free pair error (Tab. 19) is therefore the meaningful measure. On T-LESS and YCB-V it is *worse* than predicting one constant rotation, because both datasets have strong pose priors. On SYMSOL-T, where rotations are uniform, the trees beat chance only because of one shape: the cube (27.8° vs. 41.2°), plausibly because the spacecraft body is box-like. There is no general zero-shot transfer: the trees must be retrained per object.

I. Disclosures and reproducibility

- **Late feature-equivalence check.** The augmented and rotated views are extracted by a compact feature extractor. A pre-registered check against the full feature caches was run after the main results. It failed its strict element-wise tolerance: the maximum standardised difference was 0.51 for MoGe-2 features (p99 0.004; correlation 0.999998). Its functional follow-up showed that no PoE prediction changed on 512 crops, and that single-branch greedy leaves changed for 1/512 (DINOv3) and 3/512 (MoGe-2) crops.
- **SYMSOL-T bug.** Nine MoGe-2 SYMSOL-T trees first trained to NaN: always-empty border cells had a standard deviation near 10^{-6}, and float16 overflowed. They were retrained with a standard-deviation floor of 10^{-2}; all other trees were unaffected. Only the corrected evaluation is reported.
- **YCB-V paths.** A file-path error in the YCB-V manifest (colour images are JPEG) was fixed before any YCB-V result.
- **Post-hoc control.** The constant-prediction control in Tab. 19 was added after the T-LESS zero-shot result and is labelled as post hoc.

Every number in the results tables is generated by a script directly from the evaluation logs of the named runs.

J. Project details

This appendix summarises the whole project in one place: how the method works in detail, how data, training and evaluation were set up, what every experiment behind the paper found, how the design was arrived at, what failed, and what we do and do not claim. Unless stated otherwise, errors are mean geodesic rotation errors in degrees, averaged over 3 seeds, and $\pm$ is the sample standard deviation over seeds. "Synth" is the SPEED+ synthetic validation set, "val-aug" its augmented copy (Appendix J.2), and LB/SL are the lightbox and sunlamp test domains. Quaternions are scalar-first, $q = (w, x, y, z)$, and $\mathrm{Exp}(\phi\, d) = (\cos\frac{\phi}{2}, \sin\frac{\phi}{2}\, d)$ for a unit axis d.

J.1. Method details

Tesseract partition. A unit quaternion q is assigned to the chart $c = \arg\max_i |q_i|$ (first maximum on ties) and multiplied by $\mathrm{sign}(q_c)$, so q and $-q$ get the same chart and the same path. The quaternion is projected to the cube facet, $x = q/|q_c|$, and its three free coordinates $u \in [-1, 1]^3$ are halved recursively. At each level, each coordinate goes to the upper half ($b_i = 1$) if u_i is at least the interval midpoint, which gives the child id $k = b_0 + 2b_1 + 4b_2 \in \{0, \ldots, 7\}$. The leaf id at depth L is

$$\mathrm{id} = c \cdot 8^L + \textstyle\sum_{\ell=1}^{L} k_\ell\, 8^{L-\ell}, \tag{7}$$

so there are $4 \cdot 8^L$ leaves. After l decisions, free coordinate i of the cell centre is $u_i = -1 + \sum_{t=1}^{l} b_{t,i} 2^{1-t} + 2^{-l}$; the centre quaternion sets $x_c = 1$ and normalises. The tree uses cell centres only. This follows the recursive tesseract of Kurz *et al*. [15], but uses cube centres instead of corners (a corner has no unique parent), keeps only the 4 positive facets, and adds an explicit encoder, decoder and tie rule. The encoder invariants (antipodal invariance, encode–decode round trip, consistent prefixes) hold on all 69,491 SPEED+ labels.

Table 20 gives the quantisation by depth. The error halves with every level. The grid is not uniform: at L5 cell volumes differ by up to $14.4\times$, so a uniform prior over leaves is not uniform over rotations. We stop at $L = 5$: L6 would have 1,048,576 cells against 47,966 SPEED+ training images. Per hypothesis, the Tesseract is less precise than Super-Fibonacci and Hopf grids [27] of the same size (L5: 2.51° mean against 2.47° for Super-Fibonacci). Its advantage is search cost: greedy descent scores only 44 nodes at L5.

Table 20. **Tesseract quantisation by depth** ($2{\cdot}10^6$ Haar rotations). Mean: angle to the centre of the rotation's own cell (what the tree returns). Max: exact centre-to-corner bound.

L	cells	mean (°)	max (°)
1	32	39.27	81.79
2	256	19.95	46.83
3	2,048	10.01	24.43
4	16,384	5.01	12.36
5	131,072	2.51	6.20

Frozen features. Both backbones are frozen (evaluation mode, no gradients, asserted after every pass). Features are extracted once per crop and view into an fp16 cache, and the trees read only these caches.

- **DINOv3, `tokens8`.** DINOv3 ViT-L/16 [22] on a 256×256 crop with ImageNet normalisation. The last-block patch tokens ($16 \times 16 \times 1024$; CLS and register tokens dropped) are average-pooled to 8×8, giving 64×1024 tokens.
- **MoGe-2, `normals16~and`.** MoGe-2 [24] on a 518×518 crop predicts camera-frame normals n and a mask, both pooled to 74×74. The *consensus mask* m is the AND of the MoGe-2 mask (> 0.5) and a training-free DINOv3 foreground: the first principal component of the 256 patch tokens, sign-flipped so the border is background, upsampled and Otsu-thresholded. The tokens are $X = [\mathrm{pool}_{16}(n \odot m),\ \mathrm{pool}_{16}(m)] \in \mathbb{R}^{256\times 4}$. On real images the AND mask cuts the foreground outside the keypoint envelope from 0.52 to 0.12 (LB) and from 0.57 to 0.12 (SL) compared with MoGe-2's own mask.
- **Standardisation.** Every feature dimension is standardised as $(x - \mu)/(\mathrm{sd} + 10^{-6})$ with statistics from the clean training rows only (per object on the non-SPEED+ datasets), and the same statistics are applied to augmented, validation and test views. The MoGe-2 trees for three SYMSOL-T shapes use an sd floor of 10^{-2} (Appendix J.5).

Tree network. Each token is mapped by LayerNorm and a linear layer to $d = 256$, and a fixed 2-D sinusoidal encoding is added. Its frequencies are $\omega_k = 2^k\pi$ for $k = 0, \ldots, 63$, *i.e*. up to $2^{63}\pi$; only the lowest few ($2^k < 2g$ for a $g \times g$ grid) separate grid positions, and in float32 the higher channels hold fixed, position-dependent rounding residues. One pre-norm Transformer encoder layer produces the memory, and a causal decoder with 2 layers (4 heads, FFN 512, dropout 0.1) reads the sequence $(r, s_1, \ldots, s_L)$: a learned root token, then $s_{j+1} = E_{\mathrm{lev}}[j] + W\varphi(c_j)$, where c_j is the centre of the cell reached after j decisions and φ is the quaternion plus a 6-frequency Fourier encoding (52 dimensions). Output 0 feeds a 4-way chart head and output $j \geq 1$ an 8-way child head. Under teacher forcing one decoder pass gives all $1 + L$ distributions. The DINOv3 tree has 2,391,564 trainable parameters and the MoGe-2 tree 2,128,404.

Soft targets, beam search and PoE. With $\delta(q,c) = 2\arccos|\langle q,c\rangle|$ in degrees, the target at level ℓ is

$$t_k^{(\ell)} = \mathrm{softmax}_k\big(-(\delta(q,c_{\ell,k})/\tau_\ell)^2\big), \tag{8}$$

over the 4 chart centres ($\ell = 0$) or the 8 children of the *ground-truth* parent, so mass never leaves the true parent cell. The widths are fixed a priori to the mean cell error of each level: $\tau_0,\dots,\tau_5 = 39.27, 39.27, 19.95, 10.01, 5.01, 2.51°$. The loss $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{GT}}$ sums the six soft cross-entropies. Beam search keeps the B best prefixes by cumulative log-probability; greedy is $B = 1$, and beams up to 8 did not change the single-view result (PoE synth 6.242° at B=1, 6.248° at B=8). The two branches are fused at every node by the parameter-free product of experts [9],

$$\log\tilde{p}^{(\ell)} = \log\mathrm{softmax}\Big(\textstyle\sum_b \log\mathrm{softmax}(z_b^{(\ell)})\Big). \tag{9}$$

Augmentation and the exact roll. Every training crop has two pre-extracted augmented copies (seeds 1 and 2). Each copy draws a roll $\theta \sim \mathcal{U}(-180°, 180°)$ and a photometric chain: brightness, contrast, gamma, blur ($p = 0.5$), glare blobs ($p = 0.3$), Gaussian noise, random erasing ($p = 0.3$) and JPEG ($p = 0.5$). The rolled crop is resampled from the full image in one warp, so there are no black corners. A roll θ (counter-clockwise on screen) about the unit ray d through the crop centre changes the labels as

$$q' = \mathrm{Exp}(-\theta d)\otimes q, \qquad t' = \mathrm{Rot}(d,-\theta)\,t \tag{10}$$

(the "pre−" convention). It was derived from the camera geometry and checked before any training on 512 synth crops at 4 angles: keypoints agree to 0.34 px mean (1.05 px p95), the label error is 0.06° mean (1.14° max), and the other three conventions are off by 94–242 px. On SPEED+, d is computed from the *undistorted* crop centre. On T-LESS and YCB-V objects lie far from the optical axis and the affine warp failed the same rule (p95 label error 1.43° / 2.40°), so the crop is warped by the exact roll homography $C\,K\,\mathrm{Rot}(d,-\theta)\,K^{-1}$. The labels then follow exactly (error 0.000°), and the allocentric target is recomputed from t'. SYMSOL-T uses the full frame, whose centre is the principal point, so the affine roll is already exact. A roll multiplies on the left, so it commutes with right-multiplication by an object symmetry.

Orbit voting and scoring rules. At test time four views $\theta_k \in \{0, 90, 180, 270\}°$ are extracted. In each, the fused tree runs beam search with $B = 8$, and the 8 leaf centres are mapped back to view 0 by the inverse roll (on allocentric datasets via the egocentric frame, using the ground-truth translation). This gives 32 candidates. The *orbit product* maps each candidate c into every view, encodes it to its own depth-5 path, and sums the teacher-forced fused log-probabilities:

$$s(c) = \textstyle\sum_k \big[\log\tilde{p}_k^{(0)}(\text{chart}) + \sum_{\ell=1}^{5}\log\tilde{p}_k^{(\ell)}(k_\ell \mid \text{prefix})\big]. \tag{11}$$

The prediction is $\arg\max_c s(c)$. EXP-114 compared it with three simpler rules over the same candidates: *max-confidence* (highest beam score in its own view), *top-1 vote* (Gaussian-kernel support, $\sigma = 5°$, among the four view top-1s) and *weighted vote* (kernel support from all 32 candidates, weighted by the per-view softmax of beam scores). The product re-scoring costs 8.2 ms (DINOv3-only) or 15.3 ms (PoE) per image at batch 1; the weighted vote needs below 0.1 ms.

Symmetry-aware targets. For an object with symmetry set $\mathcal{S}$, three label modes were compared (EXP-106):

- **A0, single label**: the annotated rotation q_v of the view.
- **A1, canonical**: in each view separately, the equivalent $q_v \otimes s$ closest to the identity. Because it is per view, the labels of a view and its rolled copy need not be related by the roll transform.
- **A2, multi-path**: every equivalent $q_v \otimes s$ gets its own path and soft targets, and the loss is the mean of $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{GT}}$ over them (all of $\mathcal{S}$ if $|\mathcal{S}| \le 8$, otherwise 8 drawn per sample and step). For $|\mathcal{S}| = 1$ this is exactly A0.

The pre-registration named a hard-path level-marginal loss for A2. An amendment written before any run replaced it by the smoothed loss above, because the hard-path loss would not reduce to A0 for asymmetric objects.

Orbit distillation. The teacher is the frozen orbit system of the same seed and variant, applied to each training image over its three existing views (clean and two augmented copies, with known rolls). It yields 24 candidates c_j with weights $w_j = \mathrm{softmax}_j\, s(c_j)$, computed once and stored as constants. A new student tree is trained from scratch with

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{GT}} - \beta\textstyle\sum_j w_j \frac{1}{L+1}\sum_{\ell=0}^{L}\log p^{(\ell)}\big(\mathrm{pre}_\ell(c_j)\big), \tag{12}$$

where $\log p^{(\ell)}(\mathrm{pre}_\ell(\cdot))$ is the joint log-probability of the length-ℓ prefix of the candidate's path, transported into the drawn view, and $\beta = 1$ was fixed before any run. Inference is unchanged. This is data distillation [8, 21] with a hierarchical target.

Translation block. We keep the SPACE-HOP target [5] unchanged. With the ground-truth square box (b_x, b_y, b_w, b_h), image size (W, H), $\alpha = 1.6$ and $\kappa = \frac{1}{2}(\alpha b_w/W + b_h/H)$, the target is $u = \big((f_x X/Z + c_x - b_x)/b_w,\ (f_y Y/Z + c_y - b_y)/b_h,\ \kappa Z\big)$. A learned query cross-attends once (4 heads) to the tree's

encoded tokens, followed by LN $\to$ Linear$(256, 256)$ $\to$ GELU $\to$ Linear$(256, 3)$: 331,011 parameters per branch. It is trained jointly with the tree ($\mathcal{L}_{\text{GT}} + \|u - u^*\|^2$; arm J) or on a frozen tree (arm F; also used on the other datasets, where u is standardised). PoE averages the two branches' u, and orbit inference averages the four back-rolled estimates. The *box-only* reference uses no image: object centre at the box centre, depth at the training mean.

Flat baselines. The flat classifier is the same network with path decoding removed: the decoder runs on the root token alone and feeds one linear layer over K anchors. For $K = 131{,}076$ the head alone has 33,686,532 parameters (36,078,096 in total for DINOv3, against 2.4 M for the tree). It is trained with geodesic soft targets over the 32 anchors nearest to the label at the tree's leaf width $2.51°$, with the tree's optimiser, views and checkpoint rule. In orbit voting it scores a candidate by the log-probability of its hard anchor. Three grids are used: SPACE-HOP's Hopf grid at the count-matched $10{,}923 \times 12 = 131{,}076$ (EXP-113), the Tesseract's own 131,072 leaf centres, and a balanced Hopf grid $1{,}771 \times 74 = 131{,}054$ (EXP-127).

J.2. Data, training and evaluation protocol

Benchmarks. Table 21 summarises the four benchmarks. All rotation results use ground-truth square crops: the tight box of projected object points, made square with side $\max(w, h, 32\,\text{px}) \cdot 1.3$ (15% margin per side). On SPEED+, the 11 Tango keypoints are used only to build these boxes and to verify conventions, and never as a training target. *Val-aug* is the 11,994 synth images with one fixed augmented copy (seed 1000). It was added in EXP-109 as a second selection domain, because clean synth has almost no gross errors and real images may not be used for selection. On T-LESS and YCB-V the tree predicts the allocentric rotation $R_{\text{ray}}(t)^\top R$, where $R_{\text{ray}}(t)$ is the minimal rotation taking the optical axis to the object ray.

T-LESS continuous symmetries are discretised in 36 steps of $10°$, so for objects 1 and 4 our symmetry-aware error can exceed the true one by up to $5°$. Its symmetry sets have sizes 36, 36, 2, 2, 1, 1 and 4; SYMSOL-T groups have 12 (tetrahedron), 24 (cube), 60 (icosahedron), 360 (cone) and 720 (cylinder) elements. The EXP-122 YCB-V composites paste `data_syn` renders onto backgrounds drawn only from real *training* frames.

Training. Table 22 lists the shared recipe. It was fixed for SPEED+ at the Phase-3 gate, locked by DEC-018, and not tuned per dataset. One tree is trained per backbone (and per object outside SPEED+).

Metrics.

- **Rotation error** $E_R = 2 \arccos |\langle \hat{q}, q \rangle|$. The *symmetry-aware* error (T-LESS, SYMSOL-T) is $\arccos\left(\frac{1}{2}(\max_{S \in \mathcal{S}} \text{tr}(\hat{R}^\top R S) - 1)\right)$; on T-LESS the raw error is 38–47°, which is why it is needed.
- **acc@k / R@k**: fraction with error below $k°$ (strict on SPEED+, $\le$ elsewhere).
- **Severe flips**: fraction with $E_R > 150°$. Flip transitions against a reference: *fixed* = share of its $> 150°$ errors that become $< 20°$, *broken* = share of its $< 20°$ predictions that become $> 150°$.
- **Translation**: $E_T = \|\hat{t} - t\|$, normalised $e_t = E_T / \|t\|$, and T@c = fraction with $E_T \le c$ cm.
- **Official SPEED+ score** [17, 19]: the mean over images of e_q (rad) $+ e_t$, with each term set to zero below the challenge floors ($0.169°$, 2.173×10^{-3}).
- **Retention** of distillation: (base greedy − student greedy) / (base greedy − base orbit).

Outside SPEED+, errors are first averaged per object and then over objects with equal weight.

Selection and pre-registration. The split policy (DEC-000, restored by DEC-006) is: train on synthetic/train, select on synthetic validation (and from EXP-109 on also on val-aug), and treat lightbox and sunlamp as test-only and descriptive. A seeded 20% lightbox split (DEC-005) was withdrawn the same day, before it influenced any run. The other benchmarks select on held-out scenes or sequences. Each experiment has a report that records, before any run, the question, arms, selection data, metrics and pass criterion. The standard pass rule compares 3-seed means on validation data: a difference passes only if it is larger than the larger of the two seed standard deviations. Protocol changes are dated amendments written before the affected runs; deviations found later are recorded as such. Real-domain and test numbers are reported for every arm and never used for selection.

Detected crops (EXP-124). The detected-crop evaluation was pre-registered before the detector was trained. An Ultralytics YOLO11s detector (COCO-pretrained) is trained on synthetic/train only, at image size 960 for 20 epochs, with the tight keypoint box as its single-class label and the checkpoint chosen on synthetic validation. At test time the top-1 box is turned into a crop with the ground-truth rule; when there is no detection the whole image is used, and these cases are counted. Systems S1–S3 were fixed before any result, and a ground-truth-crop run with the same code must first reproduce EXP-117 rotation and EXP-118 translation.

Compute. All logged runs used one NVIDIA RTX 6000 Ada in a workstation shared with other users, so timings are upper bounds. Feature extraction on SPEED+ took 11.5 ms

Table 21. **Benchmarks.** Counts are images (SPEED+) or object instances. All crops are ground-truth square boxes with 15% margin.

	Splits (train / val / test)	Crop	Target	Metrics
SPEED+	synthetic train 47,966 / synthetic val 11,994 (+ val-aug) / lightbox 6,740, sunlamp 2,791 (test only)	11 projected Tango keypoints, with distortion; gray → 3 channels	egocentric quaternion	raw E_R, acc@$\{1, 3, 5, 10, 20\}$ ($<$), severe flips, official score
T-LESS	7 objects (1, 4, 5, 11, 18, 21, 27): PBR scenes 0–44 + real, $\leq$12,000 per object, 84,000 / PBR scenes 45–49, 14,030 / BOP19 real targets, 2,345	projected 3-D model box corners; RGB	allocentric	symmetry-aware E_R, R@$\{2, 5, 10\}$ ($\leq$)
SYMSOL-T	5 shapes: 20,000 per shape (100,000 used) / 2,000 per shape / test-5k, 25,000; rendered locally with LiePose's generator	full 224×224 frame	egocentric	symmetry-aware E_R (annotated groups), R@k
YCB-V	6 objects (PoseCNN release): real 48,316 (+ 72,000 synthetic in EXP-122) / held-out sequences 0012, 0047, 0065, 0074: 2,797 / keyframes, 3,478	projected model points; RGB	allocentric	raw E_R (no symmetry metadata)

Table 22. **Training recipe** shared by all trainers.

Epochs, batch	100, 256
Optimiser	AdamW, lr 10^{-3}, weight decay 0.05
Schedule	OneCycle, 5% warm-up
Precision	bf16 autocast, fp16 features
Tree	$d = 256$, 1 encoder + 2 decoder layers, 4 heads, FFN 512, dropout 0.1
Views	clean or augmented copy 1 or 2, drawn uniformly per sample and step
Soft targets	τ_ℓ = mean cell error of level ℓ (flat: 32 anchors, 2.51°)
Distillation	$\beta = 1$, 24 teacher candidates
Checkpoint	validated every 5 epochs; lowest clean synth greedy mean (SPEED+) or symmetry-aware val greedy mean (others)
Seeds	0, 1, 2

per image for DINOv3 and 29.2 ms for MoGe-2. A locked-recipe SPEED+ tree trains in a median of 13.3 min (DINOv3) or 5.8 min (MoGe-2), and per-object trees on the other benchmarks in a median of 2.3–11.1 min. Every heavy job runs under a memory cap and an in-process memory guard, with a watchdog over the job queues.

J.3. Results summary

Table 23 lists every experiment behind the paper with its pre-registered outcome. Two evaluation passes of the same trees can differ in the second decimal (*e.g.* sunlamp PoE + orbit is 12.28 in EXP-109/112 and 12.25 in EXP-113–117); each row quotes its own run.

Orbit voting hurts on YCB-V. With synthetic training data, orbit voting makes YCB-V validation *worse* for both variants (PoE greedy 10.52 vs orbit 12.74; DINOv3 8.97 vs 11.53), and it does not help the test mean (PoE 10.90 vs 12.16). Test seed spread is large (DINOv3 greedy ±6.90). The validation-selected YCB-V system is therefore DINOv3 single-view (test 12.92). On T-LESS real test images orbit voting helps the mean but removes few gross errors ($> 90°$ fraction 0.055 to 0.051).

Official score. On ground-truth crops the official SPEED+ score is 0.227/0.224 (LB/SL) for S1, the distilled PoE students with orbit voting plus the jointly trained DINOv3 translation block. The jointly trained 6-DoF PoE model (S2) scores 0.241/0.238. Applying the floor jointly instead of per component changes any per-seed domain score by at most 1.1×10^{-4}. The score is dominated by the rotation term (S1 on LB: 0.196 rotation, 0.031 translation).

Criteria that failed.

- **EXP-109 B**: 16×16 tokens give val-aug 30.51 vs 30.84, within the seed std, at $4\times$ the tokens.
- **EXP-114**: the orbit product does not beat the weighted vote on synth. The claim is therefore "multi-view orbit consistency over hierarchical candidates", not a specific rule; the product stays in the recipe only because DEC-018 fixed it beforehand.
- **EXP-116 criterion 1**: the hierarchical transport loss beats the base and the paired-view control but not a plain leaf-level equivariance loss, so no hierarchical-transport claim is made.
- **EXP-064 fusion on SYMSOL-T and YCB-V**: MoGe-2 adds nothing on the textureless SYMSOL-T renders and hurts on real-only YCB-V. The fusion claim is restricted to SPEED+ and T-LESS.

Distillation retention. The student recovers part of the orbit gain at single-view cost. Retention on synth / val-aug / LB / SL is 43% / 15% / 18% / 22% for DINOv3 and 30% / 13% / 28% / 23% for PoE. Clean synth also improves (DINOv3 4.57 vs 4.84, PoE 4.56 vs 4.85). Student + orbit is

Table 23. **Results summary.** Triples are synth / LB / SL; "val" is the validation split of the named dataset. Outcomes follow the larger-seed-std rule. EXP-106 and EXP-122 outcomes were evaluated from the run CSVs against the pre-registered rule.

Exp.	Question	Key numbers	Outcome
109	Do augmentation (A), 16×16 tokens (B) or orbit voting (C) help?	PoE val-aug: A 9.75 vs 30.84 (clean tree); B 30.51 vs 30.84; A+C 5.82. A+C 3.87 / 12.31 / 12.28 vs 5.54 / 26.91 / 36.66	A PASS, B FAIL, C PASS
112	Cost of the four locked systems	PoE+orbit 3.87 / 12.31 / 12.28 at 278.5 ms; DINOv3+orbit 4.21 / 17.40 / 15.27 at 69.6 ms; DINOv3 greedy 4.84 / 22.56 / 22.02 at 14.7 ms (batch 1)	descriptive
113	Tree vs flat classifier on SPACE-HOP's Hopf grid ($10{,}923 \times 12$)	PoE+orbit synth 3.87 vs 7.53, val-aug 5.82 vs 9.80; greedy 4.85 vs 8.95; LB 12.30 vs 13.15, SL 12.25 vs 16.31; 2.4 M vs 36.1 M parameters per branch	PASS (grid confounded, see 127)
114	Does the orbit product beat simpler rules?	synth: weighted vote 3.46 vs product 3.87 (PoE), 3.71 vs 4.21 (DINOv3); val-aug PoE 5.82 vs 5.98, DINOv3 6.25 vs 6.30; product best on real	FAIL on synth; marginal PASS on val-aug (PoE only)
115	Which augmentation matters?	PoE+orbit: both 3.87 / 12.30 / 12.25; photometric 4.25 / 12.29 / 12.37; roll 3.78 / 18.69 / 20.70; none 4.62 / 20.25 / 24.83	both criteria PASS (val-aug)
116	Roll-consistent hierarchical loss (T)	DINOv3 greedy val-aug: T 9.57, A 9.88, C1 10.04, C2 (leaf-only) 9.43; cons.@10 T 0.603 vs A 0.554	crit. 1 FAIL, crit. 2 PASS
117	Orbit distillation into a single-view student	student greedy val-aug DINOv3 9.33 vs 9.88, PoE 9.22 vs 9.75; student PoE+orbit 3.69 / 11.21 / 11.09	PASS
118	Translation block for 6-DoF	E_T synth: box only 0.561 m; joint DINOv3 orbit 0.059 / 0.185 / 0.183 m; joint PoE 0.093 / 0.175 / 0.194 m; PoE orbit E_R 3.86 vs 3.87	PASS (both criteria)
104	Cause of the $\sim 180°$ real errors	36–41% of $> 90°$ errors fall in 165–180° (20% if random); top-8 beam holds a path within 20° for 86% of LB; flat heads flip as often	analysis: visual near-symmetry
064	Recipe on T-LESS, SYMSOL-T, YCB-V	PoE vs DINOv3, val orbit: T-LESS 9.25 vs 9.94; SYMSOL-T 2.65 vs 2.61; YCB-V 74.06 vs 62.99. Test: T-LESS PoE+orbit 16.57, SYMSOL-T DINOv3+orbit 2.62	fusion: T-LESS PASS, SYMSOL-T FAIL, YCB-V FAIL; zero-shot: no claim
106	Symmetry targets A0 / A1 / A2	PoE greedy val: T-LESS 12.30 / 11.46 / 10.82; SYMSOL-T 3.87 / 3.40 / 2.72. PoE+orbit test: T-LESS 16.57 / 18.24 / 15.19; SYMSOL-T 2.67 / 9.69 / 2.11	PASS (both datasets)
122	YCB-V with synthetic renders	val PoE+orbit 12.74 vs 74.06 (real only); test PoE greedy 10.90, PoE+orbit 12.16	PASS
124	Official score, GT-crop reference	S1 (distilled + orbit) score LB/SL 0.227 / 0.224; S2 (joint PoE) 0.241 / 0.238; gate reproduces 11.21 / 11.09° and 0.185 / 0.183 m	descriptive; gate passed
127	Quantisation floor (no learning)	synth nearest-anchor mean / max: Tesseract L5 2.507 / 5.776; balanced Hopf 2.291 / 3.840; SPACE-HOP Hopf 6.057 / 14.973	trainings pending

the best SPEED+ system. By DEC-023 it is reported as an enhancement, and the locked recipe stays EXP-109.

Zero-shot. The frozen SPEED+ trees do not transfer to other objects. On T-LESS the pre-set rule was literally met (PoE greedy pair error 95.6° vs 104.5° chance), but a post-hoc constant prediction does better (88.7°), because T-LESS objects are seen from above a table. On YCB-V the constant gives 57.8° against 95.9° and 101.6° for the trees. On SYMSOL-T, PoE + orbit beats chance (47.8° vs 53.7°) only because of the cube.

Other findings. SYMSOL-T orbit errors can fall below the leaf quantisation floor (2.31° mean, post hoc), because the tree may pick the leaf closest to any equivalent rotation. With canonical labels (A1), the weighted vote is far better than the orbit product (SYMSOL-T val 3.04 vs 9.73); the canonical label is not related across in-plane rotations by the roll transform, so the orbit views disagree.

Cost. At batch 1, PoE + orbit takes 278.5 ms per image, and most of it is MoGe-2 (84.2 ms) and its CPU consensus mask and post-processing (80.8 ms). DINOv3 single-view takes 14.7 ms (68.1 FPS). The tree head is faster than a flat head only at large hypothesis counts: at 131k hypotheses it took 1.2 vs 3.3 ms on an A400 and 1.7 vs 12.2 ms on CPU, but at SPACE-HOP's 3,072 anchors the flat head is faster, and on a large shared GPU at batch 1 the flat 131k-way head was about $3\times$ faster (0.40 vs 1.23 ms).

Gap to fine-tuned methods. On SYMSOL-T our best orbit result (DINOv3, A2 + orbit, 2.07° test, averaged over the five shapes) is about $4\times$ LiePose's [13] 0.55°, and on T-LESS R@2 is 5.7% against 34.9%. The depth-5 quantisation floor, the frozen backbone and LiePose's ground-truth visible masks are confounded in this gap. For translation, SPACE-HOP reports E_T 0.096 / 0.302 / 0.282 m with its own box source, which is not matched to our ground-truth crops.

Pending. Detected crops (EXP-124, completed). With the synthetic-only YOLO11s detector (mean IoU 0.986 / 0.764 / 0.884 on synthetic / lightbox / sunlamp; 54 lightbox misses fall back to the full image), the primary system

reaches $3.88°/23.88°/16.42°$, $0.067/0.662/0.270\,\mathrm{m}$ and a score of $0.081/0.523/0.333$, against $0.075/0.227/0.224$ with ground-truth crops (detection gap $+0.296$ lightbox, $+0.109$ sunlamp). The box-relative translation target passes box errors directly into E_T.

The following are pre-registered, but have no results yet: **EXP-119** (orbit distillation on T-LESS and SYMSOL-T), **EXP-126** (translation on T-LESS, SYMSOL-T and YCB-V against box-only) and the **EXP-127 trainings** (tree vs flat over the identical 131,072 leaves, and vs the balanced Hopf grid). EXP-128 (deployment and quantisation of the head) is also pending (Appendix J.4). If the same-grid flat head ties the tree, the hierarchy claim is withdrawn and the EXP-113 gain is attributed to the grid.

J.4. Deployment of the downstream head

Every application shares the same frozen backbones and the same inference algorithm; what is trained and shipped per application is only the downstream head: one tree per branch (DINOv3 and, for the PoE variant, MoGe-2) and, for 6D, the translation block. The head architecture is identical for every object and dataset, so its storage, latency and memory are properties of the design and are measured once. Its accuracy under reduced precision depends on the trained weights and is measured per application with each application's own evaluator and metric. This experiment (EXP-128) was pre-registered before any run; the frozen backbone is not quantised and its cost is reported separately (Appendix A).

Precisions. fp32 is the reference. bf16 (autocast) is the precision of every other result in this paper. fp16 uses autocast. int8 is weight-only: every matmul weight of the head (all linear layers including the attention projections, 20 tensors per tree, 99.3% of its parameters) is rounded to symmetric per-output-channel int8; activations, LayerNorms, embeddings and biases stay in fp32. Its accuracy is measured by simulating this rounding; its CPU speed is measured with PyTorch's dynamic int8 kernels, which convert the linear layers but not the attention in-projections. At fp32 the DINOv3 tree occupies about 9.1 MB (2,391,564 parameters); with int8 weights the ideal size is about a quarter of that.

Criterion. A precision's loss is *negligible* if its mean error differs from fp32 by no more than the larger seed standard deviation, per application, inference mode and split (the pass rule used throughout the paper).

J.5. Project history and decisions

Phase 0: geometry (EXP-000–003). EXP-000 fixed the SPEED+ pose convention $p_{\mathrm{cam}} = R(q)\,p + r$ (keypoint boxes match with IoU 0.97 for R against 0.52 for $R^\top$). EXP-001 verified the Tesseract encoder on every label, and EXP-002/003 measured its precision and compared it with other grids. The gate set $L_{\max} = 5$ and kept a Hopf grid as the mandatory matched baseline.

Phases 1–2: branches and fusion (EXP-010–029). On a 9,500-image subset, a hierarchical MLP probe on DINOv3 `grid4` reached a synth mean of 27.7°, with real medians about $4\times$ worse. VGGT, the plan's geometric branch, was weaker everywhere and about $17\times$ slower, and MoGe-2 replaced it. A training-free consensus mask fixed MoGe-2's normals on real images. An equal-weight PoE of the two branches beat the best single branch (synth 25.9° vs 27.7°), and no reliability weighting or learned fusion beat it.

Phase 3: the tree at full data (EXP-030–036). Training on all 47,966 images cut the error about $4\times$ (MLP tree, PoE 6.24°). Of five decoder and target variants, the cross-attentive Transformer with geodesic soft targets (EXP-036) was best (PoE 5.540°; LB 26.9°, SL 36.6°) and was frozen. DINOv3 alone was then better on synth (5.35°) but far worse on real images. This exposed the selection-policy conflict that DEC-005 and DEC-006 settled in favour of the strict split policy.

Phase 4: continuous refinement and the flip audit (EXP-040–050, 104, 105). Residuals and Riemannian flows [2] improved synth precision slightly, flow-induced Tesseract masses did not help, and none of them fixed the real-domain errors. The flip audit (EXP-104) showed that these errors are 180° body-axis flips caused by visual near-symmetry: the right mode is among the tree's hypotheses but is not selected. EXP-105 confirmed that no scorer on the clean features selects it on real images. An adaptive-depth oracle (EXP-050) showed small synth headroom (0.51°), so adaptive depth became a low priority and was not pursued.

Real-domain phase (EXP-108–118). Four levers were proposed against mode selection. Augmentation plus orbit voting (EXP-109) cut the PoE errors from 26.91° / 36.66° to 12.31° / 12.28° (LB / SL), and the recipe was locked on it (DEC-018). Strengthening studies followed: tree vs flat (EXP-113), scoring rules (EXP-114), an augmentation ablation (EXP-115), two training-time alternatives to orbit voting (EXP-116, 117) and 6-DoF (EXP-118).

Cross-dataset phase (EXP-064, 106, 119, 122, 124, 126, 127). Per-object trees with the unchanged recipe worked on T-LESS and SYMSOL-T, failed on real-only YCB-V, and did not transfer zero-shot (EXP-064). Three fixes followed: symmetry-aware targets (EXP-106), synthetic YCB-V renders (EXP-122) and cross-dataset distillation (EXP-119). Matched comparisons with published work (EXP-124, 126) and the same-grid flat baseline (EXP-127) were added last.

Table 24. **Negative and abandoned directions** (synth / LB / SL in degrees unless stated).

Direction	What was tried	Outcome
Geometric branch	VGGT tokens and maps (EXP-011, 012)	Synth mean 48.7 vs 27.7 for DINOv3; about 17× slower; replaced by MoGe-2.
Spectral fusion	four CASS-inspired options (EXP-017–020)	Worse masks or pose, e.g. spectral parts synth 53.0 vs 28.5; all rejected.
Masked DINOv3	mask-weighted DINOv3 pooling (EXP-016)	Synth 27.7 to 31.1; real changed by under a degree.
Fusion weighting	reliability weights (EXP-026); weighted PoE (EXP-110)	None beat equal PoE; $w^* = 0.8$ on val-aug made LB worse (32.0 vs 26.9).
Learned fusion	token concatenation (EXP-029)	Synth 5.341 equals DINOv3 alone; LB 40.8 vs 27.9.
Decoder variants	GRU decoder (EXP-031); beam search (EXP-034)	GRU missed the rule by 0.005; beam 8 changed synth by +0.006.
Tangent residual	at GT leaf (EXP-035) and predicted leaf (EXP-040)	Gains 0.055 and 0.13 on synth only; real moved by at most 0.03.
Continuous flows	cell-conditioned refiner (EXP-041); $SO(3)$ posterior (EXP-042, 111)	Synth better; real not fixed (LB 29.85 vs 26.88); posterior over-covers (0.98 at 0.9).
Flow masses	distil flow masses into the tree (EXP-043, 044)	Fused synth not improved (5.589 at β=0 vs 5.622); stopped by rule.
Path revision	discrete flow matching [6] (EXP-108)	7.22 vs 5.54; worse on both real domains.
Adaptive depth	oracle stopping depth (EXP-050)	Synth headroom 0.51; real gain only by hedging; controllers not run.
Flip selection	candidate expansion, templates, best fit (EXP-105)	Right flip present (LB oracle 9.8) but no scorer selects it.
Kurz corner tree	8 facets, corner targets (EXP-105 arm K)	Synth 5.20 vs 5.54, but LB 28.8, SL 39.1; excluded.
Finer tokens	16 × 16 DINOv3 grid (EXP-109 B)	Val-aug 30.51 vs 30.84, within seed std.
Rotation aug.	credited for flip repair after EXP-109	Refuted by EXP-115: photometric-only matches real (LB 12.29 vs 12.30).
Consistency loss	hierarchical roll transport (EXP-116)	Not better than a leaf-only equivariance loss (9.57 vs 9.43).
Canonical labels	A1 on symmetric objects (EXP-106)	Breaks orbit voting: SYMSOL-T orbit 9.73 vs 2.65 for A0.
Real-only YCB-V	per-object trees on real videos (EXP-064)	Test 69.4 (DINOv3+orbit); memorises videos; fixed by EXP-122.

Head module	Params	fp32 (MB)	fp16 (MB)	int8 (MB)
Tree, DINOv3 branch	2,391,564			
Tree, MoGe-2 branch	2,128,404			
Translation block	331,011			

Table 25. **Size of the downstream head** per module and precision (bytes of the saved weights). Blank cells: run not yet completed.

		GPU (ms/img)				CPU, 1 thread (ms/img)	
Head	Inference	fp32	bf16	fp16	peak MB	fp32	int8
DINOv3	1 view						
	orbit (4)						
PoE	1 view						
	orbit (4)						

Table 26. **Head-only latency** (ms per image, batch 1) and peak transient GPU memory, excluding the shared backbone. Orbit: 4 views × beam 8 plus scoring of 32 candidates. Shared GPU; times are upper bounds. Blank cells: run not yet completed.

Along the way the subset-v1 feature caches of Phases 1–2 were deleted to free disk space (DEC-020), so those early runs cannot be re-evaluated without re-extracting features. Two incidents are worth knowing about. Nine SYMSOL-T MoGe-2 trees trained to NaN, because always-empty border cells had an sd of about 10^{-6} and overflowed fp16; they were retrained with an sd floor. A memory-guard false abort, caused by counting shared DataLoader pages per worker, stalled the EXP-124 queue for about 14.7 h.

Table 28 lists the decisions that shaped the final design.

Application	Inference	fp32	bf16	fp16	int8 (w)
T-LESS (A2, PoE)	1 view				
	orbit (4)				
SYMSOL-T (A2, DINOv3)	1 view				
	orbit (4)				
YCB-V (syn., DINOv3)	1 view				
	orbit (4)				
SPEED+ (distilled, PoE)	1 view				
	orbit (4)				

Table 27. **Accuracy of the head under reduced precision**: mean rotation error (°, symmetry-aware where applicable, real test sets; SPEED+ lightbox) of the validation-selected head per application, 3 seeds. Blank cells: run not yet completed.

J.6. Negative results

Table 24 lists the most important directions that failed or were abandoned. A common pattern runs through them: on SPEED+, almost every idea that read the clean-trained features improved synthetic precision but did not repair the real-domain flips. Only photometric augmentation combined with orbit voting did.

LoRA adaptation of the backbones (EXP-102) was cancelled by the user before any run, so all results use frozen backbones. The flow posterior is kept only for its density: its ground-truth log-likelihood on real images is much higher than the tree's (3.85 vs 0.98 nats on LB).

Table 28. **Key decisions** (from `outputs/DECISIONS.md`; all dates 2026).

DEC	Date	Decision
000	10-05	Train on synthetic only; select on synthetic val; real domains test-only.
001	10-08	MoGe-2 replaces VGGT as the geometric branch.
003	10-09	Fusion frozen as training-free equal-weight per-level PoE.
004 upd.	10-09	Transformer tree with geodesic soft targets (EXP-036) frozen.
006	10-10	Real-domain validation split (DEC-005) withdrawn; strict split policy restored.
008	10-13	Learned feature fusion not adopted; PoE kept.
012	10-13	Adaptive depth reduced to an oracle check; cross-dataset work after the recipe lock.
014	10-15	Augmentation, 16×16 tokens and orbit voting tested together as EXP-109.
018	10-16	Recipe lock: frozen features, one tree per branch, augmentation, PoE, orbit voting.
019	10-16	Strengthening studies: tree vs flat, scoring rules, augmentation ablation.
023	10-21	Recipe unchanged; orbit distillation reported as an enhancement.
024	10-27	Cross-dataset fixes: synthetic YCB-V, multi-path targets, cross-dataset distillation.
025	10-28	Core matched set: SPEED+ detector and official score, cross-dataset translation.
026	10-29	EXP-127: tree vs flat on the same 131,072 leaves.

J.7. Claim boundaries

Claimed.

- A lightweight hierarchical rotation predictor on frozen features: one Tesseract-path Transformer per backbone, fused per level by a training-free PoE, with about 4.5 M trainable parameters. It is far more accurate than a count-matched flat Hopf classifier (EXP-113).
- Real-domain error on SPEED+ is a mode-selection problem: the large errors are 180° flips whose correct mode is already among the hypotheses (EXP-104, 105).
- Photometric augmentation plus orbit voting resolves most flips. EXP-109 fixes 62%/80% of the $> 150^\circ$ failures (LB/SL) and breaks 0.4% of good predictions; the claim is orbit consistency, not a specific scoring rule.
- Orbit distillation improves both the single-view tree and the orbit system (EXP-117), as an enhancement.
- 6-DoF with the SPACE-HOP translation formulation, trained jointly without hurting rotation (EXP-118).
- With per-object retraining, the recipe transfers to T-LESS and SYMSOL-T, and multi-path targets (A2) improve both while keeping orbit voting effective (EXP-106).

Not claimed.

- No "first" claims: hierarchical $SO(3)$ grids, the recursive tesseract [15], flow matching for pose, test-time voting and PoE all pre-exist.
- Not a better discretisation: per hypothesis the Tesseract is less precise than Hopf and Super-Fibonacci grids. Its head is faster only at large hypothesis counts (see Cost above).
- Hierarchy vs grid is open: the EXP-113 flat grid has a floor of 6.06° against 2.51°, and the gain is not attributed to hierarchy until EXP-127 runs.
- No claim that the orbit product beats weighted voting (EXP-114), and no hierarchical-transport claim (EXP-116).
- The flow models are not calibrated, and the path flow has no geometry claim.
- Not training-free and not zero-shot: the trees are trained, and outside SPEED+ they are retrained per object.
- MoGe-2 fusion helps on SPEED+ and T-LESS only.
- External comparisons are unmatched: SPEED+ uses ground-truth crops (the box alone gives 0.56 m translation error), with a synthetic-only detector the score rises to $0.523/0.333$ (detector IoU 0.76 on lightbox), and our T-LESS crops are not masked, unlike LiePose's [13].
- Experiments never evaluated together are not combined (*e.g.* the recipe with $w = 0.8$).